Polynomial Upper Bounds on Characteristic-Data Length for Multiple Context-Free Languages under Fixed Finite-Semigroup Typing

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Abstract

We study positive-data learning of multiple context-free languages that are tuple-substitutable under a fixed finite-semigroup typing and bound the total encoded length of characteristic samples relative to their MCFG presentations. Qualitative identification follows Yoshinaka's distributional framework; our contribution is quantitative. With the alphabet, fan-out, rule rank, and typing fixed, a reduced good grammar G of rule thickness $\bar{\theta}_G$ admits characteristic data of length $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$ for prefix–suffix-window typings combined with any finite, possibly noncommutative, group, and of length $O(\|G\|^3\bar{\theta}_G)$ when the positive typing image is a local group. The proofs shorten interleaved tuple components simultaneously while preserving ordered group products. A further refinement-thickness dichotomy characterizes local groups as precisely the finite-semigroup regime admitting polynomially bounded full yield-type refinement thickness at every fixed fan-out; this is distinct from a lower bound on characteristic-data length. General input MCFGs are covered by parameterized bounds using component-pattern thickness, which may be exponential in grammar size. A separate conservative learner gives Gold identification. We exhibit a class-wide finite-feature bias for cross-serial languages and explicit characteristic samples for that family. Whether the local-group condition is necessary for polynomial characteristic-data length at fan-out two or more remains open.

Keywords: grammatical inference; multiple context-free grammars; positive data; finite-semigroup typing; multidimensional substitutability; Gold identification; rule rank.

1 Introduction

Positive-data grammatical inference asks when a language can be identified in the limit from positive examples alone [1, 2]. Distributional learning answers this question by treating words, or tuples of words, that occur in common contexts as candidate constituents. The approach began with substitutable CFGs [3, 12] and was extended to multiple context-free grammars (MCFGs), whose tuple-valued nonterminals express discontinuous and cross-serial dependencies [13, 14, 29, 30]. Yoshinaka's finite-signature generalization [15] provides positive-data identification and, in the corresponding bounded-rank specialization, characteristic samples consisting of polynomially many words.

The question: how long must characteristic data be? A sample of polynomial *cardinality* may still contain exponentially long words. We therefore measure a finite sample K by its total encoded length $\|K\|_+ = \sum_{w\in K}(|w| + 1)$, not merely by $|K|$. This follows the polynomial *thick-data*

perspective reviewed by Eyraud, Heinz and Yoshinaka [10, Section 2.5.2]: the size of a grammar and the length needed to exercise its productive rules are distinct resources. Our aim is to bound the total encoded length of characteristic data relative to an MCFG presentation of the target. Qualitative identification is inherited from Yoshinaka's framework; the contribution of this paper is quantitative.

The setting: a fixed finite-semigroup typing. We study this question for learners equipped with a finite bias. Before any data are seen, we fix a fan-out bound f and a surjective finite-semigroup homomorphism $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$, called a *typing*. The learner compares observed *nonempty* tuple components only when their s-values agree; the target class $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ consists of the f-MCFLs that are tuple-substitutable under this restriction (Definition 2.8). The canonical fresh-identity completion $\widehat{s} : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{S}^\sharp$ is used to type grammar yields and evaluate rule templates, including empty terminal factors. The substitutability condition itself compares nonempty tuple components using s. Fixing the typing in advance separates the choice of a finite bias from learning under that bias [5]. Prefix–suffix windows, values in a finite group, their products, and DFA transition morphisms are typical instances. Other biases restrict derivations by regular control sets [6, 7] or restrict the evidence used to compare factors [9, 11].

The typing is a *class-level* bias: it is supplied once, before the target is known, and is not chosen to recognize each target separately. Finite features, such as morphological compatibility or case licensing, can constrain substitution between discontinuous constituents while the MCFG accounts for unbounded dependencies. For example, fix one window–group typing $s = (s_{1,1}, g)|_{\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{feat}}}$ for *every* $R \subseteq \{0,1\}^2$, and consider

$$L_R = \{\mathtt{a}^m \mathtt{p}_i \mathtt{b}^n \mathtt{c}^m \mathtt{q}_j \mathtt{d}^n : m, n \geq 1,\ (i,j) \in R\}.$$

Every L_R belongs to $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{2,s}$, and for nonempty R these are non-context-free cross-serial languages (Corollary 6.4). The group component g records the two feature *values*, not the compatibility relation R; neither R nor a target grammar is an input to the learner, which must recover both the licensing information and the unbounded crossing dependencies from positive examples. Explicit characteristic samples of encoded length at most $36|R| + 22$ exist for $R \neq \emptyset$, while every sample characteristic for a single set-driven operator on the whole family must exhibit every licensed pair (Proposition 6.5). The nonrectangular instance $R = \{(0,0), (0,1), (1,0)\}$ shows that untyped and boundary-only substitutability both fail here (Proposition 6.3).

Why bound the original presentation? A natural route is to refine the grammar by types and apply untyped estimates to the refinement. This route can be expensive. The full typed construction may contain as many as $|V||\mathsf{T}^\sharp|^f$ nonterminals and $|P||\mathsf{T}^\sharp|^{fr}$ rules, and its thickness can explode. This is a *potential* cost, not a monotonicity theorem for minimal characteristic-data length, but it can be exponential: for a fixed two-element typing $s_{\mathtt{c}}$ there are rank-two CFG presentations G_n of $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\}^+$ with $\|G_n\| = O(n)$ and rule thickness $\theta_{G_n} \leq 2$, whose trimmed full yield-type refinement has thickness $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_{n,0}} \geq 2^n$ (Proposition 4.4). We therefore bound characteristic data directly in terms of the original presentation, and ask when the algebra of the fixed typing permits short witnesses *before* this cost is paid. For the same reason we treat the typing as given rather than something to infer or optimize: a finer typing $s \preceq t$ (that is, $\ker t \subseteq \ker s$ on Σ^+) enlarges the class, $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s} \subseteq \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,t}$, but it also changes the reconstruction operator and may leave the algebraic regimes covered by our bounds. We ask when a fixed, externally given typing has class-uniform short witnesses.

The technical obstacle. To obtain short representatives of prescribed root types, we replace selected long subderivations by shorter derivations that need not preserve the componentwise group values of the replaced subtrees. In a multi-component MCFG derivation, one subtree may contribute several blocks to different root components, interleaved with blocks from other subtrees. For noncommutative groups, the effect of simultaneous replacements depends on the order of these blocks. The key quantitative step is an *owner-wise simultaneous selection* of replacements that preserves the ordered group product of every root component, even though individual replacement blocks may change their group values (Proposition 4.6).

Main results. Two input-sensitive thickness scales appear. For a reduced good MCFG G, the primary scale is its *rule thickness* $\bar{\theta}_G = \max\{1, \theta_G\}$: the maximum, over rules, of the shortest accepted sentence using that rule (Section 4.1). For an arbitrary standard MCFG H, the normalization bounds use instead the *component-pattern thickness* $\bar{t}_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$, which measures the shortest way to realize each feasible pattern of nonempty tuple components (Definition 4.18). The two scales are not interchangeable for inputs with empty components; Table 1 compares them with the auxiliary quantities used in the proofs. With the alphabet, fan-out f, rule-rank bound $r_{\max}$ and typing fixed, write $\bar{\theta} = \bar{\theta}_G$ for a reduced good grammar G, and $n = \max\{1, \|H\|\}$, $t = \bar{t}_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$ for a standard input grammar H. The principal bounds on total encoded characteristic-data length for the set-driven Const/Link/Comp reconstruction operator are:

Fixed typing / rank	Reduced good $(\|G\|, \bar{\theta})$	Any standard input (n, t)	Source
Rule rank ≤ 1; any typing	—	$O(n^3)$	Thm. 5.1
Prefix–suffix window	$O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta})$	$O(n^3 t)$	Thm. 4.9
Window with finite group	$O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta})$	$O(n^3 t)$	Thm. 4.10
Positive image in **LG**	$O(\|G\|^3\bar{\theta})$	$O(n^4 t)$	Thm. 4.15

The finite group may be noncommutative. The arbitrary-input column follows from Corollary 4.20 via normalization controlled by component-pattern thickness (Proposition 4.19), and the rank-one row is a separate normalization argument. The bounds are *class-uniform*: they apply to every $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ admitting a presentation of the stated form, with constants independent of the particular target. The hidden constants depend on f, $r_{\max}$, $|\Sigma|$ and the typing, and may grow rapidly with them; for noncommutative-group shortening they contain $M_{A,f} = U_f \max\{3, |A|^f\}^{2^{f^2}}$, which may grow doubly exponentially with f. The abelian case has sharper constants (Theorem 4.11). A separate conservative learner gives Gold identification.

The obstruction of Proposition 4.4 has an exact algebraic boundary. Corollary 4.16 shows that the typings whose positive image is a local group, and only those, give uniformly polynomial full-refinement thickness at every fan-out; unlike the characteristic-data theorems, this needs no target-specific substitutability hypothesis. It concerns refinement thickness, and is *not* a lower bound on characteristic-data length.

Further results include a local-group sufficient condition strictly beyond $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ (Proposition B.5), a rule-only computable witness budget (Proposition 5.2), and an intrinsically rank-two example (Theorem 6.11). Theorem 5.4 complements the class-uniform bounds: it gives a polynomial bound for targets that *have* a representation $L = \widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$ for an abelian-group morphism φ and a subgroup H, even when the auxiliary abelian group is infinite. This is not a bound for every member of $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, and neither the window–group nor the local-group bound assumes such a representation. A refinement s' of s may put an individual example into this form, but it changes the supplied typing and hence the reconstruction operator. The typing-class separations in Section 6 do not assert that either shortening technique is necessary for any single example.

Relation to prior work. The following comparison concerns the guarantees used in this paper; it does not attempt an exhaustive classification of prior learning models.

Source	Established scope	Present additional question
Yoshinaka (2008) [12]	(k,ℓ)-substitutable CFGs; characteristic-data size with a grammar-thickness parameter	Higher-fan-out, fixed-group, and LG-typed shortening
Yoshinaka (2009, 2011) [13, 14]	Multidimensionally substitutable MCFGs and positive-data learning; polynomial identification in the corresponding grammar regime	Original-thickness bounds under supplied finite-semigroup typing
Yoshinaka (2015) [15]	Finite-signature and disjoint-sort learning principles, including finite witness cardinality under fixed bounded-rank signatures	Encoded-length upper bounds that survive the typing refinement

The Const/Link/Comp construction specializes Yoshinaka's qualitative learning principle rather than claiming it as new. The finite-semigroup structure theory and local-group/delay representations used here are classical [36–38]. The qualitative learning principles and finite witness-cardinality results are due to Yoshinaka [14, 15]. Classical sliding-factor coordinates serve as input to our new shortening step rather than a separate novelty claim; the rank-one obstruction uses [21, 22]. Our independent contribution is the noncommutative owner-wise shortening, the resulting window–group and local-group bounds (Theorems 4.10 and 4.15), and the normalization controlled by component-pattern thickness. A related, separately submitted manuscript addresses finite-semigroup-typed CFG learning [25]; no lower-bound construction or sharpness theorem from that manuscript is reproduced or used as a premise here. Positive-data learning of other mildly context-sensitive formalisms is studied in [19], and MCFG learning with membership queries or dual context sets in [16, 18, 20]. A recent substitution lemma for MCFLs [23] is a necessary condition for membership, not a learning criterion.

Scope and organization. The characteristic-data guarantees apply to the specified reconstruction operator and the stated grammar presentations; no presentation-independent stage of Gold convergence is claimed. The bounds measure total encoded length, not an intrinsic minimum grammar size; for general standard inputs, component-pattern thickness may be exponential in grammar size. The polynomial exponents are not established as optimal. The local-group condition is sufficient at every fixed fan-out; whether it is necessary for polynomial characteristic-data length at fan-out two or more is open (Open Problem 7.1). Section 2 fixes the setting, Section 3 defines the reconstruction operator and its qualitative guarantees, Sections 4 and 5 prove the quantitative bounds, and Section 6 compares the typed classes with multidimensional substitutability and develops the examples. The appendices prove the technical shortening, normalization and reconstruction statements.

2 Preliminaries

Throughout, Σ is a finite alphabet, ε the empty word and $\Sigma^+ := \Sigma^* \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$. If $\Sigma = \emptyset$, the only languages are $\emptyset$ and $\{\varepsilon\}$ and are handled directly. For a finite $K \subseteq \Sigma^*$ put $\|K\|_+ := \sum_{w\in K}(|w|+1)$, and for a tuple $\vec{u} = (u_1, \ldots, u_d)$ put $\|\vec{u}\|_1 := \sum_i |u_i|$. Every polynomial bound below states whether it concerns cardinality or $\|\cdot\|_+$. The table fixes symbols used across sections; all others (sliding-factor labellings, auxiliary morphisms, padding lengths) are defined where they occur.

Symbol	Meaning
$G,\ H$	a (reduced good) MCFG; an arbitrary standard input MCFG
B, C, X, Y	nonterminals; X, Y also denote typed nonterminals where specified
$\|G\|$, θ_G, t_G	encoding size (Definition 2.5), rule thickness, nonterminal thickness
s, $\widehat{s}$, S	positive typing, its fresh-identity completion, its positive image
$\preceq$	kernel refinement (Definition 2.3), also between monoid morphisms on Σ^*
A	a finite group in group-theoretic lemmas (otherwise locally defined); A an abelian group in Section 5.3
g	a monoid morphism $\Sigma^* \to A$ into a finite group
T	a derivation tree

2.1 Positive-Data Learning

Definition 2.1 (Text, TxtEx identification, conservativeness)**.** Fix a pause symbol $\perp \notin \Sigma$. A *text* for $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is an infinite sequence over $L \cup \{\perp\}$ in which every element of L occurs; the *content* of a finite prefix is the set of elements of Σ^* occurring in it. A *learner* is a computable map from finite prefixes to grammars. It *TxtEx-identifies* L [1] if on every text for L its outputs are, from some stage on, one fixed grammar H with $L(H) = L$; it TxtEx-identifies a class if it does so for each member. It is *conservative* if it changes its hypothesis only on a datum $w \in \Sigma^*$ not generated by the current hypothesis. We fix a hypothesis H_0 with $L(H_0) = \emptyset$.

Definition 2.2 (Set-driven operator and characteristic sample)**.** A *set-driven reconstruction operator* $\mathcal{B}$ maps each finite $K \subseteq \Sigma^*$ to a grammar $\mathcal{B}(K)$ depending only on the set K; it is *sample-consistent* if $K \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}(K))$ for all K. A finite $\mathcal{F} \subseteq L$ is a *characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}$ and L* if $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) = L$ for every finite K with $\mathcal{F} \subseteq K \subseteq L$ (cf. [4]). This constrains generated languages only: $\mathcal{B}(K)$ need not stabilize syntactically as K grows.

2.2 Fixed Finite-Semigroup Typing

Definition 2.3 (Typing, fresh completion, refinement)**.** A *typing* is a surjective semigroup morphism $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$ onto a finite semigroup, given by the multiplication table of S and the images of the letters, so that $s(w)$ is computable in time $O(|w|)$; S is its *positive image*. (A morphism into a larger finite semigroup is replaced by its corestriction to the image.) Let $\mathsf{S}^\sharp := \mathsf{S} \uplus \{\mathbf{1}_\sharp\}$ be obtained by adjoining a *fresh* identity, even if S already has one, and let $\widehat{s} : \Sigma^* \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}^\sharp$ be the monoid morphism with $\widehat{s}(\varepsilon) = \mathbf{1}_\sharp$ and $\widehat{s}|_{\Sigma^+} = s$. For $\vec{w} \in (\Sigma^*)^d$ put $\widehat{s}^{(d)}(\vec{w}) := (\widehat{s}(w_1), \dots, \widehat{s}(w_d))$; on $(\Sigma^+)^d$ this is $s^{(d)}(\vec{w})$. For typings s, t write $s \preceq t$ if $\ker t \subseteq \ker s$ on Σ^+, and let (s, t) be the typing $w \mapsto (s(w), t(w))$ onto its image in $\mathsf{S} \times \mathsf{T}$; thus $s, t \preceq (s, t)$. Write s_{triv} for the one-element typing.

The fresh completion evaluates grammar templates (including empty terminal gaps) and types tuple yields in the refinement of Section 3.2; its new identity is not a positive-word type. Algebraic conditions such as **LG** concern S, not $\mathsf{S}^\sharp$. A finite-monoid morphism $q : \Sigma^* \to N$ determines the positive typing $q|_{\Sigma^+}$: by Lemma E.1(i), it gives the same target class and set-driven reconstruction rules as the fresh completion of that typing. Lemma E.1(ii) additionally identifies their trimmed yield-type refinements for *good* grammars. This last identification is not asserted for arbitrary standard grammars with empty-component yields.

Definition 2.4 (Prefix–suffix typing)**.** For $k, \ell \geq 0$ put $m_0 := \max\{1, k + \ell\}$, and for $|w| \geq m_0$ let $\mathrm{pref}_k(w)$, $\mathrm{suf}_\ell(w)$ be the prefix and suffix of the indicated lengths (length-zero windows are ε). Define

$$\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(w) = \begin{cases} w, & |w| < m_0, \\ \langle \mathrm{pref}_k(w), \mathrm{suf}_\ell(w) \rangle, & |w| \geq m_0, \end{cases}$$

with disjoint tags for short words and pairs, and put $M_{k,\ell} := \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(\Sigma^*)$. For short x, y and pairs $\langle u, v\rangle, \langle u', v'\rangle$ define

$$x \cdot y := \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(xy), \qquad x \cdot \langle u, v\rangle := \langle \mathrm{pref}_k(xu), v\rangle,$$
$$\langle u, v\rangle \cdot y := \langle u, \mathrm{suf}_\ell(vy)\rangle, \quad \langle u, v\rangle \cdot \langle u', v'\rangle := \langle u, v'\rangle.$$

The *boundary typing* is $s_{k,\ell} := \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}|_{\Sigma^+}$; a typing s with $s \preceq s_{k,\ell}$ is (k,ℓ)-*boundary-determined*, or briefly a *boundary typing*.

A case check on the lengths of $x, y \in \Sigma^*$ gives $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(xy) = \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(x) \cdot \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(y)$. Since $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ is onto $M_{k,\ell}$, the product is associative and $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(\varepsilon)$ is an identity, so $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ is a finite-monoid morphism. The short-word tag separates ε from $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(\Sigma^+)$, so $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ is isomorphic to the completion $\widehat{s_{k,\ell}}$.

2.3 Multiple Context-Free Grammars

Definition 2.5 (Standard MCFG presentation and size)**.** An MCFG [29, 30] is $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ with finite V, $S \in V$, $\mathrm{fan}(S) = 1$ and $\mathrm{fan}(A) \geq 1$. A rule of rank $r \geq 0$ is $A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$ with template $\rho = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$, $d_0 = \mathrm{fan}(A)$, $d_j = \mathrm{fan}(B_j)$, where each α_i is a word over $\Gamma_\rho := \Sigma \uplus \Xi_1 \uplus \cdots \uplus \Xi_r$, $\Xi_j := \{\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{d_j}\}$, and every variable occurs at most once in $\alpha_1 \cdots \alpha_{d_0}$ (*linearity*). For $\vec{u}_j \in (\Sigma^*)^{d_j}$, $\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)$ substitutes $u_{j,\kappa}$ for ξ_j^κ; for $r = 0$ the rule is a *constant rule*. The tuple languages $L_A(G) \subseteq (\Sigma^*)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$ form the least family closed under the rules, and $L(G) := \{w : (w) \in L_S(G)\}$. We write $A \Rightarrow_G^* \vec{u}$ for a *terminal derivation* (a finite derivation tree rooted at A, evaluated bottom-up); one from S is *successful*. G is an f-MCFG if $\mathrm{fan}(A) \leq f$ for all A, and has rule-rank cap $r_{\max}$ if all ranks are at most $r_{\max}$. Such a presentation, with no further restriction, is called *standard*. Its *size* is

$$\|G\| := |V| + \sum_{(A \to \rho(B_1,\ldots,B_r)) \in P} \Big(1 + r + \textstyle\sum_i |\alpha_i|\Big),$$

where $|\alpha_i|$ counts terminal and variable occurrences. All bounds use this symbol-level size; a bit-level encoding with binary nonterminal names changes it by at most a factor $O(\log \|G\|)$.

$\mathsf{MCFL}(f, r)$ is the class of languages of MCFGs of fan-out $\leq f$ and rule rank $\leq r$; f-MCFL $= \bigcup_{r<\infty} \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r)$, and the minimum rule rank of a language is taken over all its fan-out-$\leq f$ presentations. For nonterminals of equal fan-out d, $A \to B$ abbreviates $A \to (\xi_1^1, \ldots, \xi_1^d)(B)$, and $A \to \vec{c}$ a constant rule. Rule variables are always ξ_j^κ; terminals in examples are in `typewriter` font. Fan-out and rank are distinct resources. At fixed fan-out at least two the rule-rank hierarchy does not collapse in general, although adjacent levels can coincide; in particular $\mathsf{MCFL}(2, 2) = \mathsf{MCFL}(2, 3)$ [24, 32]. By contrast, fan-out-one CFGs can be binarized. The reconstruction below therefore assumes neither a binary normal form nor a known rank cap.

Definition 2.6 (Grammar properties)**.** A rule is *nondeleting* if every variable occurs exactly once in its template; a nondeleting rule is *nonpermuting* if for each j the variables $\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{d_j}$ occur in this order in $\alpha_1 \cdots \alpha_{d_0}$, and *nonmerging* if moreover no α_i contains a factor $\xi_j^\kappa \xi_j^{\kappa+1}$. Following [14, Section 2.3], a rule is λ-*free* if no α_i is empty. A rule, template or grammar is *good* if it is λ-free, nondeleting, nonpermuting and nonmerging. A nonterminal A is *reachable* if there is a chain $S = A_0, \ldots, A_m = A$ in which each A_{i+1} is a child in a rule for A_i, and *productive* if $L_A(G) \neq \emptyset$; G is *reduced* if every nonterminal is both.

In a λ-free grammar every component of every derived tuple is nonempty (induction on derivations). λ-freeness concerns template components and is distinct from $\varepsilon \notin L(G)$.

2.4 Tuple Contexts and Substitutability

A *sentence context of arity d* is a word $E = v_0\Box_1 v_1 \cdots v_{d-1}\Box_d v_d$ with each hole occurring once, $v_0, v_d \in \Sigma^*$ and $v_1, \ldots, v_{d-1} \in \Sigma^+$; $\mathcal{E}_d$ is the set of these *admissible* contexts [14, Section 3.1]. $E[\vec{w}]$ fills $\Box_i$ by w_i, $|E|_{\text{fix}} := \sum_{i=0}^{d} |v_i|$, and E *accepts* $\vec{w}$ in L if $E[\vec{w}] \in L$. The *d-tuple distribution* of $\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^*)^d$ is $\mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) := \{E \in \mathcal{E}_d : E[\vec{x}] \in L\}$; at fan-out one it is the two-sided distribution $\{(u, v) : uxv \in L\}$.

Definition 2.7 (Tuple occurrence)**.** For $w = a_1 \cdots a_n$ number the cut positions $⓪a_1① \cdots a_n⓷$ and write $w[i : i'] := a_{i+1} \cdots a_{i'}$. An *arity-d tuple occurrence* in w is a sequence $0 \le i_1 < i'_1 < i_2 < i'_2 < \cdots < i_d < i'_d \le n$; it determines $\vec{x} = (w[i_1 : i'_1], \ldots, w[i_d : i'_d]) \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ and the context $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$ obtained by replacing these intervals by $\Box_1, \ldots, \Box_d$, so that $E[\vec{x}] = w$. For finite K, $\text{Obs}_d(K) := \{\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^+)^d : E[\vec{x}] \in K \text{ for some } E \in \mathcal{E}_d\}$ is the set of tuples arising from such occurrences, and $\text{Obs}(K) := \bigcup_{1 \le d \le f} \text{Obs}_d(K)$ for the fixed fan-out bound f.

Definition 2.8 ((f, s)-tuple substitutability and the target class)**.** Let $f \ge 1$ and let s be a typing. A language $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is (f, s)*-tuple-substitutable* if for every $1 \le d \le f$ and all $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$,

$$s^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s^{(d)}(\vec{y}) \;\text{ and }\; \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) \cap \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y}) \neq \emptyset \implies \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y}).$$

$\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$ is the class of (f, s)-tuple-substitutable f-MCFLs; a member of $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$ for a boundary typing s is *boundary-typed*. For $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ write $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,s}^{d} \vec{y}$ (or $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{y}$) if $s^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ and $\mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y})$; this is an equivalence relation.

Empty components are never compared, following [14, Section 3.1 and footnote 3] (see [8] for CFGs), and $\varepsilon \in L$ is handled at the start symbol; otherwise already $\mathtt{a}^+$ would fail, since $\mathtt{a}$ and ε share a context but not their distributions. The bias consists of both s and f:

(a) If $s \preceq t$, equal t-types are equal s-types, so $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,t}^{\text{mcf}}$; in particular $\mathcal{C}_{f,s_{\text{triv}}}^{\text{mcf}} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$. This compares classes only: the operators $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,t}$ of Section 3 differ in general (they coincide when $\ker s = \ker t$), and no monotonicity of characteristic-data length in the typing is claimed.

(b) $\mathcal{C}_{f+1,s}^{\text{mcf}} \cap f\text{-MCFL} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$, but the class is not monotone in f: for trivial typing $\{w\#w^R\}$ is 1- but not 2-dimensionally substitutable [14, Section 3.1, Example 5].

(c) For every $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq \mathsf{S}^\sharp$, $\widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$: it is regular, and componentwise equal types give equal total types in every context.

Proposition 2.9 (Intersection and abelian filtering)**.** *Fix f and s.*

(i) If L_1, L_2 are (f, s)-tuple-substitutable, so is $L_1 \cap L_2$.

(ii) If L is (f, s)-tuple-substitutable, A is an abelian group, $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{A}$ a monoid morphism, $\mathsf{H} \le \mathsf{A}$ and $\gamma \in \mathsf{A}$, then $L \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$ is (f, s)-tuple-substitutable.

Whenever such an intersection is an f-MCFL, it belongs to $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$; in particular so does every f-MCFL $\widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$. Such factorizations are not supplied to the learner.

Proof. (i) A context accepting equal-type $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ in $L_1 \cap L_2$ accepts both in each L_i, so their distributions agree in each L_i, hence in the intersection. (ii) If some context E accepts $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ in $\varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$, then $\delta := \sum_i (\varphi(y_i) - \varphi(x_i)) \in \mathsf{H}$, and by commutativity $\varphi(E'[\vec{y}]) - \varphi(E'[\vec{x}]) = \delta$ for every $E' \in \mathcal{E}_d$, so coset membership transfers in both directions. Thus $\varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$ is (f, s_{triv})-, hence (f, s)-tuple-substitutable; apply (i). The last two claims follow from (i), (ii) and item (c) above. □

3 Reconstruction and Qualitative Learning

This section fixes the reconstruction operator analysed later and records its qualitative guarantees, none of which is claimed as new. For fixed f, rank cap and typing, our operator follows the distributional reconstruction pattern for substitutable languages over finite signatures in [15]. We use the MCFG signature of [15, Example 3] with tuple sorts refined by s-types (cf. [15, Section 8]). The related qualitative results are

Here	Related prior result	Treatment here
Prop. 3.10 (soundness)	[15, Lemma 2]	—
Prop. 3.11 (completeness)	[15, Lemma 3]	arbitrary same-type representatives
Thm. 3.13 (exact reconstruction)	[15, Lemmas 2–3]	as for Prop. 3.11
Cor. 3.16 (identification)	[15, Theorem 1]	unbounded rank over the class

The table records qualitative analogues rather than literal identities of reconstruction operators. The concrete grammar statements and their adaptations are verified directly in Appendices D and E; no embedding into the signature framework is used as a premise. For a fixed sample the uncapped operator is the finite cap $\|K\|_+$, so soundness needs no addition; but identifying all of $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, whose members have unbounded minimum rank, uses a sample-dependent cap, outside the bounded-arity assumption of [15]. Representatives that are not derivable from their nonterminal are used in Proposition 5.3 and hence Theorem 5.4. Finally, [15] bounds the *number* of characteristic words by the number of target rules and nonterminals; their *length*, which this paper bounds, is not addressed there.

3.1 Set-Driven Reconstruction

All interaction between templates and contexts rests on one observation.

Lemma 3.1 (Induced child contexts)**.** *Let $\rho = (\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_e)$ be a good template of rank r with child arities $d_1, \dots, d_r$, let $E \in \mathcal{E}_e$, let $1 \le j \le r$, and fix $\vec{u}_i \in (\Sigma^+)^{d_i}$ for $i \neq j$. Let E_j be the word obtained from $E[(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_e)]$ by replacing ξ^κ_j by $\square_\kappa$ and every other variable ξ^ι_i by $u_{i,\iota}$. Then $E_j \in \mathcal{E}_{d_j}$ and $E_j[\vec{x}] = E[\rho(\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_{j-1}, \vec{x}, \vec{u}_{j+1}, \dots, \vec{u}_r)]$ for every $\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^*)^{d_j}$.*

Proof. The identity holds because substitutions commute. By linearity and nondeletion each $\square_\kappa$ occurs exactly once in E_j, and by nonpermutation in the order $\kappa = 1, \dots, d_j$, since E places $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_e$ from left to right. Consider ξ^κ_j and $\xi^{\kappa+1}_j$. If both lie in one α_i, nonmerging puts a terminal or a variable ξ^ι_i with $i \neq j$ between them, which becomes a nonempty word. Otherwise they lie in $\alpha_i, \alpha_{i'}$ with $i < i'$, and the material between them contains the separator $v_i \in \Sigma^+$ of E. So every internal separator of E_j is nonempty. □

Lemma 3.2 (Composition preserves equivalence)**.** *Let $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$, let ρ be a good template of rank r, and let $\vec{x}_j, \vec{u}_j \in (\Sigma^+)^{d_j}$ satisfy $\vec{u}_j \equiv_{L,s} \vec{x}_j$ for every j. Then $\rho(\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r) \equiv_{L,s} \rho(\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_r)$.*

Definition 3.3 (Composition witness)**.** Let K be finite and $r \ge 1$. A *composition witness of rank r* in K is a triple $(\vec{z}, \rho, (\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r))$ in which ρ is a good template of rank r with output arity $e \le f$ and child arities $d_1, \dots, d_r \le f$, $\vec{z} \in \mathrm{Obs}_e(K)$, $\vec{u}_j \in (\Sigma^+)^{d_j}$, and $\vec{z} = \rho(\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r)$.

Equivalently, a composition witness is a segmentation of the components of an observed $\vec{z}$ into terminal gaps and nonempty intervals labelled by variables, subject to the good-template conditions. If $E[\vec{z}] \in K$, Lemma 3.1 gives $E_j[\vec{u}_j] = E[\vec{z}] \in K$ with E_j admissible, so every $\vec{u}_j \in \mathrm{Obs}(K)$. The children occupy disjoint, nonempty parts of $\vec{z}$, so

$$r \le \textstyle\sum_j \|\vec{u}_j\|_1 \le \|\vec{z}\|_1 \le \max_{w \in K} |w| \le \|K\|_+. \tag{3.1}$$

Definition 3.4 (Capped and uncapped reconstruction operators)**.** Fix f and a typing s. For $r_{\max} \geq 1$ let $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K) = \widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$ be the grammar with start symbol $\widehat{S}$, a nonterminal $[\vec{x}]$ of arity d for each $\vec{x} \in \mathrm{Obs}_d(K)$, $1 \leq d \leq f$, and the rules

(Start) $\widehat{S} \to [(w)]$ for $w \in K \cap \Sigma^+$, and $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$ if $\varepsilon \in K$;

(Const) $[\vec{x}] \to \vec{x}$ for every $\vec{x} \in \mathrm{Obs}(K)$;

(Comp) $[\vec{z}] \to \rho([\vec{u}_1], \ldots, [\vec{u}_r])$ for every composition witness of rank $1 \leq r \leq r_{\max}$;

(Link) $[\vec{x}] \to [\vec{y}]$ for $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in \mathrm{Obs}_d(K)$ with $s^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ and $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}] \in K$ for some $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$.

For $K \neq \emptyset$ put $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K) := \widehat{G}(K) := \widehat{G}_{\leq \|K\|_+}(K)$; $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(\emptyset)$ has no rules. Fixed encoding orders make both operators deterministic and set-driven.

By (3.1), $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)$ contains a Comp rule for every composition witness in K. Both operators are sample-consistent, via $\widehat{S} \to [(w)] \to (w)$ and $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$. All non-start templates are λ-free, so $\widehat{S} \Rightarrow^* \varepsilon$ only by the rule $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$. For trivial typing and $\varepsilon \notin K$, Comp/Const, Link and Start correspond to the rule Types I–III of [14, Section 4.1], and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ corresponds to the operator of the unbounded-rank learner $\mathcal{A}(p, *)$ of [14, Corollary 2].

3.2 Yield-Typed Refinement and Witnesses

Definition 3.5 (Yield-type refinement)**.** Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be a finite nondeleting MCFG and s a typing. For a template ρ and $\mathbf{t}_j \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{d_j}$, let $\mathrm{out}_\rho(\mathbf{t}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{t}_r) \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{d_0}$ have ith component the image of α_i under the monoid morphism $\Gamma_\rho^* \to \mathsf{S}^\sharp$ extending $a \mapsto \widehat{s}(a)$ and $\xi_j^\kappa \mapsto (\mathbf{t}_j)_\kappa$. The *full yield-type refinement* $G^{\widehat{s}}$ has a fresh start symbol $\widetilde{S}$, nonterminals $A_{\mathbf{t}}$ for $A \in V$ and $\mathbf{t} \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$, start rules $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(\eta)}$ for $\eta \in \mathsf{S}^\sharp$, and for every rule $A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$ (including $r = 0$) and all $\mathbf{t}_j \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{\mathrm{fan}(B_j)}$ the rule $A_{\mathrm{out}_\rho(\mathbf{t}_1,\ldots,\mathbf{t}_r)} \to \rho(B_{1,\mathbf{t}_1}, \ldots, B_{r,\mathbf{t}_r})$. The *trimmed refinement* $\widetilde{G}_0$ keeps exactly the nonterminals and rules occurring in some successful derivation from $\widetilde{S}$. Unless $G^{\widehat{s}}$ is named, *typed nonterminals* and *typed rules* are the non-start nonterminals and rules of $\widetilde{G}_0$, and $L_X := \{\vec{u} : X \Rightarrow^*_{\widetilde{G}_0} \vec{u}\}$.

Typed rules have the templates of their sources, so $\widetilde{G}_0$ is good whenever G is; each L_X is nonempty, and its tuples have nonempty components if G is λ-free.

Proposition 3.6 (Yield-type invariants)**.** *(i) If $A_{\mathbf{t}} \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$ in $G^{\widehat{s}}$, then $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$, and erasing indices gives a G-derivation of $\vec{u}$.*

(ii) Every terminal derivation $A \Rightarrow^*_G \vec{u}$ lifts uniquely to $A_{\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{u})} \Rightarrow^*_{G^{\widehat{s}}} \vec{u}$; a successful derivation of w lifts uniquely through $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(\widehat{s}(w))}$.

(iii) $L(\widetilde{G}_0) = L(G^{\widehat{s}}) = L(G)$.

Lemma 3.7 (Canonical contexts for typed nonterminals)**.** *Let G be good. Every typed nonterminal X of arity d has a context $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_d$ with $\chi(X)[\vec{u}] \in L(G)$ for all $\vec{u} \in L_X$; if $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is in $\widetilde{G}_0$, one may take $\chi(X) = \Box_1$.*

Lemma 3.8 (Typed nonterminals are distributionally homogeneous)**.** *Let G be good of fan-out $\leq f$ with $L := L(G) \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. For every typed nonterminal X of arity d, L_X lies in a single $\equiv^d_{L,s}$-class, denoted $[X]$.*

The proofs of these three statements are in Appendix E. The homogeneity of Lemma 3.8 is weaker than that of congruential MCFGs [17], whose contexts may have empty separators.

Definition 3.9 (Canonical tuples, contexts and the witness set)**.** Let G be good. For every typed nonterminal X fix a *canonical tuple* $\omega(X) \in L_X$ and a *canonical context* $\chi(X)$ as in Lemma 3.7, with $\chi(X) = \square_1$ whenever $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is in $\widetilde{G}_0$. Let $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ consist of the words

$$\chi(X)[\omega(X)] \ \ (X \text{ typed}), \qquad \chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_q))] \ \ (X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q) \text{ typed}, \ q \geq 0).$$

Since $\omega(X)$ and $\rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_q))$ belong to L_X, $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ is a finite subset of $L(G)$, nonempty if $L(G) \neq \emptyset$, and $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)|$ is at most the number of typed nonterminals and rules. Canonical objects are properties of the target, not inputs of the operator: qualitatively any choice works, while Section 4 chooses short ones.

3.3 Qualitative Guarantees

Proposition 3.10 (Soundness of every hypothesis)**.** *Let L be (f,s)-tuple-substitutable and $K \subseteq L$ finite. For every $r_{\max} \geq 1$, if $[\vec{x}] \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$ in $\widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$, then $\vec{u} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{x}$. Consequently $L(\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,s}(K)) \subseteq L$ and $L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)) \subseteq L$.*

Proposition 3.11 (Completeness from a witness assignment)**.** *Let G be a finite good MCFG of fan-out $\leq f$, let r_G be the maximum rank of a typed rule of $\widetilde{G}_0$ ($r_G := 0$ if none), and assign to each typed nonterminal $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ a tuple $\iota(X) \in (\Sigma^+)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$ with $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\iota(X)) = \mathbf{t}$ and a context $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$, with $\chi(X) = \square_1$ if $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is in $\widetilde{G}_0$. Suppose K contains $\chi(X)[\iota(X)]$ for each X and $\chi(X)[\rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_q))]$ for each typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$, $q \geq 0$. Then*

$$L(G) \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,s}(K)) \quad (r_{\max} \geq \max\{1, r_G\}), \qquad L(G) \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)).$$

Neither substitutability nor $\iota(X) \in L_X$ is assumed; $\iota = \omega$ is the case $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \subseteq K$.

Exact reconstruction needs a good presentation of the target; the following normalization controls size, fan-out and rank, but not thickness (for reduced λ-free inputs, see Proposition F.2).

Proposition 3.12 (Good normalization with rank preservation)**.** *Let G_{in} be a finite standard f-MCFG of rule rank at most $r_{\max}$. There is a finite good f-MCFG G_{good} of rule rank at most $r_{\max}$ with $L(G_{\mathrm{good}}) = L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$ and, for fixed $f, r_{\max}$, $\|G_{\mathrm{good}}\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$. If $L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \cap \Sigma^+ \neq \emptyset$, G_{good} is reduced.*

Theorem 3.13 (Exact reconstruction for a fixed typing)**.** *Fix $f \geq 1$ and a typing s, and let $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. If $L \cap \Sigma^+ = \emptyset$ put $\mathcal{F}_L := L$ and $r_G := 0$. Otherwise let G be a reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$ presentation of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ (Proposition 3.12), let r_G be as in Proposition 3.11, and put $\mathcal{F}_L := \mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$. Then $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq L$ is finite, and every finite K with $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq K \subseteq L$ satisfies*

$$L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)) = L, \qquad L(\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,s}(K)) = L \quad \text{for every } r_{\max} \geq \max\{1, r_G\}.$$

If $L \in \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r)$, G can be chosen of rank $\leq r$, so $r_{\max} = \max\{1, r\}$ suffices (also when $r = 0$).

Theorem 3.14 (Polynomial construction under a rule-rank cap)**.** *Fix $f, r_{\max} \geq 1$ and s. The encoding of $\widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$ is computable in time $(1 + \|K\|_+)^{O(f r_{\max})}$; its fan-out is at most f and its rank at most $r_{\max}$.*

Definition 3.15 (Conservative sequential learner)**.** The learner $\mathcal{A}_{f,s}$ (respectively $\mathcal{A}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$) starts with H_0, keeps its hypothesis on $\perp$ and on every datum the hypothesis generates, and otherwise replaces it by $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)$ (respectively $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$), where K is the content read so far. This is the policy of [14, Algorithm 1].

Corollary 3.16 (Gold identification)**.** *Fix $f \geq 1$ and s.*

(i) *$\mathcal{A}_{f,s}$ TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$.*

(ii) *For fixed $r_{\max}$, $\mathcal{A}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}} \cap \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r_{\max})$, and processes each datum in time polynomial in $\|K\|_+$ for the content K read so far.*

Proofs are in Appendix D (Proposition 3.12: Appendix F). None of these statements bounds the length of characteristic data or the stage of convergence.

4 Characteristic-Data Bounds

Throughout this section f, $r_{\max} \geq 1$, Σ and the typing $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$ are fixed; $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ is a reduced good MCFG of fan-out $\leq f$ and rule rank $\leq r_{\max}$, and $\widetilde{G}_0$ is its trimmed $\widehat{s}$-refinement. Under a rank cap, Theorem 3.13 already supplies $O(\|G\|)$ characteristic words; the task is to bound their total length *in terms of G*. All bounds follow one scheme.

(1) *Witness length* (Lemma 4.2). If, for an auxiliary finite-monoid morphism λ refining s, every tuple of every nonterminal can be exchanged for a tuple of the same nonterminal and the same λ-vector of total length at most β, then $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ is characteristic and has total length $O(\|G\|(\bar{\theta}_G + \beta))$.

(2) *Minimal counterexamples* (Section 4.3). In a shortest derivation with a prescribed root λ-vector, a large antichain of heavy subtrees would admit a simultaneous replacement preserving that vector; so antichains are small, and Lemma 4.5 turns this into $\beta = O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$ or $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$.

(3) *Regimes.* Only λ and the replacement step change: window typings keep marked boundary letters; window–group typings in addition preserve ordered group products (Proposition 4.6); local-group typings reduce to these through sliding-factor coordinates (Section 4.5).

The full yield-type refinement is not used to measure thickness, since its thickness can be exponential in that of G (Proposition 4.4); exactly when this happens is characterized in Corollary 4.16. Section 4.6 transfers all bounds to arbitrary standard input grammars.

4.1 Thickness Scales and Witness Length

For a rule R of G let

$$\theta_G(R) := \min\{\, |w| : w \in L(G) \text{ has a successful derivation using } R \,\},$$

the length of the derived *sentence*, not of the derivation. Put $\theta_G := \max_{R \in P} \theta_G(R)$, $\bar{\theta}_G := \max\{1, \theta_G\}$ and $t_G := \max_{A \in V} \min\{\|\vec{w}\|_1 : \vec{w} \in L_A(G)\}$ (rule and nonterminal thickness; Yoshinaka writes τ_G for θ_G [14, Section 4.3]). Table 1 lists these scales together with the pattern scale of Section 4.6 and two auxiliary quantities; θ_{typ} and κ_G compare G with its own trimmed refinement and are not parameters of the main theorems.

If a target L contains ε, every statement below is applied to $L \cap \Sigma^+$ and the datum ε is added, as in Theorem 3.13; this adds one to the encoded length.

Table 1: Thickness scales: two theorem parameters and three auxiliary quantities.

Scale	What it measures / role	Comparison or obstruction
θ_G	Shortest accepted sentence using each rule, maximized over rules; *primary for reduced good G.*	$t_G \le \theta_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$ (Lemma 4.1).
t_G	Largest minimum total yield length of a nonterminal; proof-scale for good forms.	Polynomially equivalent to θ_G on reduced good presentations.
$t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H)$	Largest minimum yield length over *realized nonempty-component support patterns*; *primary for arbitrary H.*	$t_H \le t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H)$, with equality for reduced λ-free H; the family E_n has $\theta_{E_n} = O(n)$ but $t_{\mathrm{pat}}(E_n) \ge 2^n$ (Prop. F.3).
θ_{typ}	Rule thickness of the trimmed full yield-type refinement $\widetilde{G}_0$; baseline only.	$\theta_{\mathrm{typ}} \ge \theta_G$; it can be $\ge 2^n$ with $\theta_G \le 2$ (Prop. 4.4).
κ_G	Shortest representative of each typed distribution class, maximized over classes; auxiliary for abelian-filtered targets.	$\kappa_G \le \theta_{\mathrm{typ}}$; representatives need not be derivable from the typed nonterminal (Prop. 5.3).

Lemma 4.1 (Thickness lemma)**.** *Let G be reduced and good.*

(i) *Every rule writes at most θ_G terminal symbols explicitly.*

(ii) *$t_G \le \theta_G$: every $A \in V$ has some $\vec{u} \in L_A(G)$ with $\|\vec{u}\|_1 \le \theta_G$.*

(iii) *$\theta_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$.*

(iv) *Every $A \in V$ of fan-out d has a context $E_A \in \mathcal{E}_d$ with $|E_A|_{\mathrm{fix}} \le \theta_G$ that results from a successful derivation by deleting one occurrence of an A-subtree; $E_S = \square_1$, and $E_A[\vec{u}] \in L(G)$ for all $\vec{u} \in L_A(G)$. For every typed nonterminal $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$, the choice $\chi(X) := E_A$ meets Definition 3.9 and is* derivational *for X: it results from a successful derivation of $\widetilde{G}_0$ by deleting an occurrence of an X-subtree.*

Proof. For a rule R with left-hand side A fix a successful derivation D_R of length $\theta_G(R)$ that uses R; it exists because G is reduced. By nondeletion every terminal written by R, and every component of the tuple produced at that occurrence of A, survives exactly once in the sentence. This gives (i), and (ii) because every productive A has a rule.

(iv) For $A = S$ take $\square_1$. Otherwise delete the A-subtree of D_R and put ordered holes in place of its components; iterating Lemma 3.1 along the path to the root (siblings have nonempty yields) shows $E_A \in \mathcal{E}_d$, and its fixed letters belong to the sentence of D_R. Inserting any A-derivation gives a successful derivation, so E_A accepts $L_A(G) \supseteq L_X$ (Proposition 3.6(i)). A typed nonterminal with a start link has the form $S_{\mathbf{t}}$, and $E_S = \square_1$. For derivationality, insert the erasure of any $\widetilde{G}_0$-derivation D_X from X into the hole; the unique lift of the resulting successful derivation (Proposition 3.6(ii)) labels every node by its nonterminal and the $\widehat{s}$-vector of its yield, as D_X does, so it contains D_X at the hole, and deleting that X-subtree leaves E_A.

(iii) Follow a shortest dependency path from S to A; it repeats no nonterminal, so its rules are distinct and differ from R. Complete every sibling on the path and every child of R by a shortest terminal tuple (length $\le t_G$) and apply R. The distinct rules used write at most $\|G\|$ terminals and have at most $\|G\|$ child occurrences, so the sentence has length at most $\|G\| + \|G\| t_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$. □

Thus θ_G and t_G are polynomially equivalent on reduced good presentations; Yoshinaka's efficiency criterion measures data in target size and rule thickness [14, Definition 1]; see also [10].

For a finite-monoid morphism $\lambda : \Sigma^* \to N$ we write $s \preceq \lambda$ if $\ker(\lambda|_{\Sigma^+}) \subseteq \ker s$; since $\widehat{s}$ separates ε, this is the relation of Definition 2.3 whenever λ also separates ε from Σ^+. For $\beta \ge 0$ consider

($\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta}$) for every $B \in V$ and $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$ there is $\vec{u}' \in L_B(G)$ with $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}') = \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u})$ and $\|\vec{u}'\|_1 \le \beta$.

Put

$$C_s(G) := |V||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f + |P||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}} \;\le\; |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\,\|G\|,$$

using $|V| + |P| \le \|G\|$; it bounds the numbers of typed nonterminals and typed rules together, since a typed rule is determined by its source rule and the type vectors of its at most $r_{\max}$ children.

Lemma 4.2 (Witness length)**.** *Let $\lambda : \Sigma^* \to N$ be a finite-monoid morphism with $s \preceq \lambda$.*

(i) (Type-preserving exchange.) *If $X = B_{\mathbf{t}}$ is a typed nonterminal, $\vec{u} \in L_X$, $\vec{u}' \in L_B(G)$ and $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}') = \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u})$, then $\vec{u}' \in L_X$. Hence under ($\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta}$) there are canonical tuples with $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le \beta$ for every X.*

(ii) (Length.) *If $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le b$ for every X and $\chi(X) := E_B$ as in Lemma 4.1(iv), every word of $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ has length at most $2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b$, and*

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \le C_s(G), \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le C_s(G)\,(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b).$$

(iii) (Refined thickness.) *In (ii), each rule word $\chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \dots, \omega(Y_q))]$ is the yield of a successful derivation of $\widetilde{G}_0$ using the typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$; hence $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_0} \le 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b$.*

(iv) (Characteristic sample.) *If $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$ for some $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, then $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ and for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$.*

Items (i)–(iii) do not use substitutability.

Proof. (i) All components are nonempty because G is λ-free, so $s \preceq \lambda$ and Proposition 3.6(i) give $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}') = \widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$. By Proposition 3.6(ii) a G-derivation of $\vec{u}'$ lifts to a $G^{\widehat{s}}$-derivation from X. Inserted at an occurrence of X in a successful derivation of $\widetilde{G}_0$ it gives a successful derivation, because typed rules depend only on typed symbols; so all its rules are retained and $\vec{u}' \in L_X$. For the second claim apply ($\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta}$) to some $\vec{u} \in L_X \neq \emptyset$.

(ii) A witness word is $\chi(X)[\omega(X)]$ or a rule word. The context has at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ fixed letters, a typed rule has the template of its source and so writes at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ letters (Lemma 4.1(i)), and there are at most $r_{\max}$ child tuples. There is one word per typed nonterminal and per typed rule.

(iii) Apply the typed rule to $\widetilde{G}_0$-derivations of the $\omega(Y_j) \in L_{Y_j}$, erase the labels, and insert the result into the successful G-derivation from which E_B was obtained. As in the proof of Lemma 4.1(iv), the unique lift contains the typed derivation at the hole, and every rule of a successful derivation of $G^{\widehat{s}}$ is retained. A start link $\widetilde{S} \to S_{\mathbf{t}}$ is used by the successful derivation of $\omega(S_{\mathbf{t}})$, of length at most b.

(iv) Proposition 3.11 with $\iota = \omega$ ($r_G \le r_{\max}$, and $\chi(S_{\mathbf{t}}) = E_S = \square_1$) and Proposition 3.10 give $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) \cap \Sigma^+ = L \cap \Sigma^+$ for every finite K with $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \subseteq K \subseteq L$; the Start rule handles ε. □

4.2 Refined-Thickness Baseline

Put $\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}} := \max\{1, \theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}\}$, the rule thickness of the trimmed refinement itself. Every rule R of G has a retained typed copy (lift a successful derivation using R), and every successful derivation using a copy erases to one using R; hence $\theta_G \le \theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}$.

Lemma 4.3 (Refined-thickness baseline)**.** *Canonical tuples can be chosen so that $\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le C_s(G)\,(1 + (r_{\max} + 2)\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}})$.*

Proof. $\widetilde{G}_0$ is reduced and good, so Lemma 4.1(ii) applied to it gives $\omega(X) \in L_X$ with $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le \theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}$. Apply Lemma 4.2(ii) with $b = \theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}$ and use $\bar{\theta}_G \le \bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}}$. □

For trivial typing a nonterminal of a λ-free grammar has a single type, so $\widetilde{G}_0$ is G with a start link, and the lemma recovers Yoshinaka's untyped estimates $|K_G| \le |P|$ and $\|K_G\| \le |P|\theta_G$ [14, Lemma 7 and Theorem 1]. Under a nontrivial typing the refinement can be much thicker:

Proposition 4.4 (Exponential blow-up of full yield-type refinement)**.** (a) *Let $e \ne z$ be idempotents of S with $ez = ze = z$, and let $u, v \in \Sigma^+$ with $s(u) = e$ and $s(v) = z$. For $n \ge 1$ let G_n be the fan-out-one, rank-two grammar*

$$S \to SS \mid a\ (a \in \Sigma) \mid A_0 \mid \cdots \mid A_n, \qquad A_0 \to u, \qquad A_i \to A_{i-1}A_{i-1} \mid v \quad (1 \le i \le n),$$

where u, v are constant templates. Then G_n is reduced and good, $L(G_n) = \Sigma^+$, $\|G_n\| = O_{\Sigma,u,v}(n)$, $\theta_{G_n} \le \max\{2, 2|u|, 2|v|\}$, and $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_{n,0}} \ge |u|2^n$.

(b) *In particular, for $\Sigma = \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\}$ and the two-element typing $s_{\mathtt{c}}$ onto $\{1, \zeta\}$ ($\zeta^2 = \zeta$) with $s_{\mathtt{c}}(\mathtt{a}) = 1$, $s_{\mathtt{c}}(\mathtt{c}) = \zeta$, taking $u = \mathtt{a}$, $v = \mathtt{c}$ gives $\|G_n\| = O(n)$, $\theta_{G_n} \le 2$ and $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_{n,0}} \ge 2^n$.*

Proof. All templates are nonempty and use each variable once in order, so G_n is good; it is reduced and generates Σ^+ via $S \to SS \mid a$. Each rule has a successful use of length at most $\max\{2, 2|u|, 2|v|\}$: complete every A_i by v ($i \ge 1$) or u ($i = 0$). A yield of A_n is a product of leaf values $s(u) = e$ and $s(v) = z$; since $e^2 = e$ and z is absorbing in $\{e, z\}$, its type is e iff no leaf uses v. Hence the unique yield of $(A_n)_{(e)}$ is u^{2^n}; the typed rule $S_{(e)} \to (A_n)_{(e)}$ is retained (via $S \to A_n$), and every successful derivation using it has length at least $|u|2^n$. In (b), $e = 1$ and $z = \zeta$. □

This obstruction concerns the refinement, not characteristic-data length for Σ^+ or for any operator. The proofs below therefore work on G itself.

4.3 Short Representatives by Minimal Counterexamples

Let $\lambda : \Sigma^* \to N$ be a finite-monoid morphism. A vector $\mathbf{t} \in N^d$ is *realizable at B* (of fan-out d) if $\mathbf{t} = \lambda^{(d)}(\vec{u})$ for some $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$. A *λ-minimal* derivation for $(B, \mathbf{t})$ is a terminal derivation from B with root λ-vector $\mathbf{t}$ that minimizes first the total yield length and then the number of nodes. For a threshold b, a node is *heavy* if its yield has total length greater than b.

Lemma 4.5 (Heavy-node count)**.** *Let $b \ge \bar{\theta}_G$ and $c \ge 0$, and let T be λ-minimal for $(B, \mathbf{t})$. If every antichain of heavy nodes of T has at most c elements, then*

$$\|\textit{root tuple of } T\|_1 \le (r_{\max} + 1)\, b \max\{1, c\,|V||N|^f\}.$$

Proof. Label each node by its nonterminal and the λ-vector of its yield; there are at most $|V||N|^f$ labels. If an ancestor and a proper descendant had the same label, replacing the ancestor's subtree by the descendant's would keep the root λ-vector (templates evaluate λ homomorphically), would not lengthen the root yield (by linearity the descendant's yield is part of the ancestor's), and would remove nodes, contradicting minimality. So every root-to-leaf path has at most $|V||N|^f$ nodes. If the root is light its yield has length at most b. Otherwise the heavy nodes form an ancestor-closed subtree whose leaves form an antichain, so there are at most $c|V||N|^f$ heavy nodes. Every terminal of the root yield is written by a heavy node (at most $\bar{\theta}_G \le b$ each, Lemma 4.1(i)) or lies in a light child of a heavy node (at most $r_{\max}$ children of length at most b). □

Group constants. For a finite abelian group H, $\mathsf{d}(H)$ is the maximal length of a zero-sum-free sequence over H (so $\mathsf{d}(H)+1$ is the Davenport constant; $\mathsf{d}(\{1\})=0$). For a finite group A and $f \geq 1$ put

$$N_{A,f} = \max\{3, |A|^f\}, \quad U_f = f^{f+1} f!, \quad M_{A,f} = U_f \, N_{A,f}^{2^{f^2}}, \qquad c_{A,f} := \begin{cases} \mathsf{d}(A^f), & A \text{ abelian}, \\ M_{A,f} - 1, & \text{otherwise}. \end{cases}$$

U_f bounds the number of block patterns of one owner, and $N_{A,f} \geq 3$ is needed by the order classification in Appendix A.1.

Simultaneous block replacement. A *block-replacement family* of width f over A (Definition A.1) consists of $d \leq f$ rows, each an ordered product in A of fixed constants and *blocks*; each block has an *owner* in $[m]$, an original value and a replacement value, and each owner owns at most f blocks, which may interleave with other owners' blocks arbitrarily. $\mathrm{val}_c(J)$ is the value of row c when exactly the blocks of owners in $J \subseteq [m]$ take their replacement values.

Proposition 4.6 (Simultaneous block replacement)**.** *In a block-replacement family of width f over a finite group A with $m > c_{A,f}$ owners there is a nonempty $J \subseteq [m]$ with $\mathrm{val}_c(J) = \mathrm{val}_c(\varnothing)$ for every row c. Individual block or owner values need not be preserved.*

Proof. This is Lemma A.2. For abelian A one selects a nonempty zero-sum subsequence of the owners' difference vectors in $A^d \leq A^f$. For arbitrary A no factors are commuted: among owners with a common block pattern (at most U_f patterns) one homogenizes all pairwise order comparisons (Lemma A.7), which decomposes every row into consecutive rank chunks (Lemma A.4); a pigeonhole on prefix-product boundary states then yields an interval of owners preserving all ordered row products (Lemma A.5). □

Owner contributions cannot be commuted: if the two rows are $\beta_{1,1}\beta_{2,1}$ and $\beta_{2,2}\beta_{1,2}$, with value $\sigma = (12)$ on the blocks of owner 1 and $\tau = (23)$ on those of owner 2 in S_3, the row values are $\sigma\tau \neq \tau\sigma$. Example A.6 shows a replacement preserving rows of opposite owner orientation.

Lemma 4.7 (Short representatives for window–group invariants)**.** *Fix $k, \ell \geq 0$, a finite group A (possibly trivial) and a morphism $g : \Sigma^* \to A$. Put $\lambda := (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g) : \Sigma^* \to N := M_{k,\ell} \times A$ and $h := f(k+\ell+1)$. Then $(\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta})$ holds with*

$$\beta = b_{k,\ell,A} := (r_{\max}+1)\,\bar{\theta}_G\,(c_{A,f}+h)\,|V||N|^f \;\leq\; (r_{\max}+1)(c_{A,f}+h)|N|^f\,\|G\|\,\bar{\theta}_G.$$

Proof. Let $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$, $\mathbf{t} := \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u})$, and let T be λ-minimal for $(B, \mathbf{t})$, with heavy threshold $b = \bar{\theta}_G$. In each root component of length at least $m_0 = \max\{1, k+\ell\}$ mark the first k and the last ℓ positions (one arbitrary position if $k = \ell = 0$), and in each shorter component mark all positions: at most h marks. Let Q be an antichain of heavy nodes. Incomparable subtrees have disjoint yields, so at most h nodes of Q contain a mark; let Q_0 be the others.

Suppose $|Q_0| > c_{A,f}$. For $v \in Q_0$ with nonterminal C_v fix a tuple of $L_{C_v}(G)$ of total length at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ (Lemma 4.1(ii)). By linearity and nondeletion each $v \in Q_0$ contributes at most f disjoint contiguous blocks to the root components, and the g-value of each root component is the ordered product of the g-values of fixed material and of these blocks. This is a block-replacement family over A with owners Q_0, so Proposition 4.6 gives a nonempty $J \subseteq Q_0$ whose simultaneous replacement preserves every root g-value. The replaced blocks contain no mark: short root components are untouched, and in a long component they lie strictly between the marked prefix and suffix, which keep their letters and positions relative to the ends, while the component keeps its $k+\ell$ marked

letters (at least one if $k = \ell = 0$) and stays long. So the root $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$-vector is preserved as well, and the result is a derivation from B with root λ-vector $\mathbf{t}$ that is strictly shorter, since each replaced yield exceeded $\bar{\theta}_G$. This contradicts minimality.

Hence every heavy antichain has at most $c_{A,f} + h$ elements, and Lemma 4.5 with $c = c_{A,f} + h \geq 1$ gives the bound; the second inequality uses $|V| \leq \|G\|$. □

Corollary 4.8 (Window representatives)**.** *For $k, \ell \geq 0$, $(\mathrm{R}_{\beta}^{\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}})$ holds with $\beta = b_{k,\ell} := (r_{\max} + 1)\bar{\theta}_G\, f(k+\ell+1)\,|V||M_{k,\ell}|^f$.*

Proof. Take A trivial in Lemma 4.7: then $c_{A,f} = 0$ and $N \cong M_{k,\ell}$. □

4.4 Window and Window–Group Typings

Theorem 4.9 (Polynomial data for prefix–suffix-determined typings)**.** *Let $s \preceq s_{k,\ell}$, let $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ and $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$. Then $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ with $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \leq C_s(G) = O(\|G\|)$ and*

$$\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \leq K_{k,\ell}\,\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G, \qquad K_{k,\ell} := |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\big(3 + r_{\max}(r_{\max}+1)f(k+\ell+1)|M_{k,\ell}|^f\big).$$

Proof. Corollary 4.8 and Lemma 4.2(i),(ii),(iv) with $\lambda = \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ and $b = b_{k,\ell}$ give the sample and $\|\mathsf{W}\|_+ \leq C_s(G)(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b_{k,\ell})$; insert $C_s(G) \leq |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\|G\|$, $1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G \leq 3\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G$ and $|V| \leq \|G\|$. □

Theorem 4.10 (Polynomial characteristic data for window–finite-group typing)**.** *Let A be a finite group, $g : \Sigma^* \to A$ a morphism, and $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g)$; let $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ and $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$. Then $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ with $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \leq C_s(G) = O(\|G\|)$ and*

$$\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \leq K_{k,\ell,A}\,\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G,$$
$$K_{k,\ell,A} := |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\big(3 + r_{\max}(r_{\max}+1)(c_{A,f} + f(k+\ell+1))(|M_{k,\ell}||A|)^f\big).$$

The group may be noncommutative and its blocks may interleave across components.

Proof. As for Theorem 4.9, with Lemma 4.7 and $b = b_{k,\ell,A}$. □

Theorem 4.11 (Polynomial data for window–abelian typing)**.** *If in Theorem 4.10 the group A is abelian, then $c_{A,f} = \mathsf{d}(A^f) = O(\exp(A)\, f \log|A|)$ (Remark A.3), so $K_{k,\ell,A}$ is polynomial in f apart from the factors $|\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}$ and $(|M_{k,\ell}||A|)^f$; for nonabelian A, $c_{A,f} = M_{A,f} - 1$ grows doubly exponentially in f.*

Proof. Lemma A.2(a). □

At fan-out one, polynomial time and thick-data learning for fixed windows is due to Yoshinaka [12, Theorem 1]; the bounds above are relative to a reduced good presentation and are not claimed to improve on that result after normalization. What is new is that window and ordered group values are preserved *simultaneously* across up to f interleaved components. This higher-rank regime is needed at the language level: Theorem 6.11 gives a non-context-free $(1,1)$-typed target of minimum fan-out two and minimum rule rank two, whereas rank one is covered by Theorem 5.1.

4.5 An Algebraic Criterion for Polynomial Characteristic Data

LI is the pseudovariety of finite locally trivial semigroups ($eSe = \{e\}$ for every idempotent e), **Grp** that of finite groups, and $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ consists of the divisors of products $S \times A$ with $S \in \mathbf{LI}$ and A a finite group [27, 28]. The following lemma makes the window–group hypothesis intrinsic to the positive image S; the semigroup facts are classical [26].

Lemma 4.12 (Locally trivial–group typings admit window–group refinements)**.** *Let $\Sigma \neq \emptyset$. If $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$, there are $k \geq 1$, a finite group A and a morphism $g : \Sigma^* \to A$ with $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,k}, g)$; if $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI}$, A can be trivial.*

Proof. Choose a finite $S' \in \mathbf{LI}$, a finite group A, a subsemigroup $T \leq S' \times A$ and a surjective morphism $\pi : T \to \mathsf{S}$ (for $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI}$: $S' = \mathsf{S}$, $A = \{1\}$). Lifting each $s(a)$ to $(\sigma_a, g_a) \in T$ defines a morphism $\rho = (\sigma, g) : \Sigma^+ \to T$ with $\pi\rho = s$; put $g(\varepsilon) = 1_A$. The subsemigroup $S_0 := \sigma(\Sigma^+) \leq S'$ is locally trivial; let $n := |S_0|$. Two facts:

(a) $S_0^n \subseteq S_0 E(S_0) S_0$. Let t_i be the prefix products of $s_1 \cdots s_n$. If $t_i = t_j$ with $i < j$, then $t_i = t_i u = t_i u^\omega$ for $u = s_{i+1} \cdots s_j$, so the product is $t_i u^\omega y$ with $y \in S_0^1$; otherwise the t_i exhaust S_0, one of them is an idempotent e, and the product is ey. In both cases it is xey with $x, y \in S_0^1$, and $xey = (xe)e(ey)$.

(b) $euf = ef$ for $e, f \in E(S_0)$ and $u \in S_0^1$: $euf = eu(fef) = (e(uf)e)f = ef$.

For $|w| \geq 2n$ write $w = pxz$ with $|p| = |z| = n$. By (a), $\sigma(p) = aeb$ and $\sigma(z) = cfd$ with $a, b, c, d \in S_0$ and e, f idempotent, and by (b) $\sigma(w) = ae\,(b\,\sigma(x)c)\,fd = aefd$ (with $\sigma(\varepsilon) := 1$), which depends only on $p = \mathrm{pref}_n(w)$ and $z = \mathrm{suf}_n(w)$. Shorter words are recorded exactly by $\widehat{s}_{n,n}$, which also separates ε. Hence equal $(\widehat{s}_{n,n}, g)$-values imply equal ρ-values and equal s-values; take $k = n$. □

Corollary 4.13 (Algebraic sufficient condition for polynomial data)**.** *If $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$, then for every $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ and every G as above with $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$, $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ of cardinality $O(\|G\|)$ and total length $O_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$.*

Proof. Lemma 4.12 and Theorem 4.10; k, A and g depend only on s. □

A finite semigroup is a *local group*, $S \in \mathbf{LG}$, if eSe is a group for every idempotent $e \in S$. This is always tested on the positive image S, never on $\mathsf{S}^\sharp$. By Proposition B.5, $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp} \subsetneq \mathbf{LG}$.

Definition 4.14 (Local-group typing)**.** Fix $k \geq 1$, a finite group A and a map $\nu : \Sigma^{k+1} \to A$ (the *sliding-factor labelling*). For $|w| \geq 2k$ let $\sigma_k(w) = (F_1, \ldots, F_{|w|-k})$ be the factors of length $k+1$ of w in order of their starting positions, and put $\gamma_{k,\nu}(w) := \nu(F_1)\nu(F_2)\cdots\nu(F_{|w|-k})$ (ordered product in A); put $\gamma_{k,\nu}(w) := 1_A$ for $|w| < 2k$. The *local-group typing* is $\lambda_{k,\nu}(w) := (\widehat{s}_{k,k}(w), \gamma_{k,\nu}(w))$; by Lemma B.1 it is a morphism onto a finite monoid $M_{k,\nu}$. The typing s is *local-group-determined* if $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda_{k,\nu}$ for some k, A and ν.

Theorem 4.15 (Polynomial characteristic data for local-group typing)**.** *Let $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}$, $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ and $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$. Then $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ with*

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| = O(\|G\|), \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ = O_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}(\|G\|^3 \bar{\theta}_G).$$

Proof. By Theorem B.4, $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda := \lambda_{k,\nu}$ for $k = |\mathsf{S}|$ and some A, ν depending only on s. Lemma B.6 gives $(\mathrm{R}_\beta^\lambda)$ with $\beta = \beta_\lambda = O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$: heavy subtrees are first exchanged for short tuples with the same window vector (Corollary 4.8), and then a nonempty family is selected whose ordered sliding-factor products remain unchanged (Lemma B.2 and Proposition 4.6). Lemma 4.2 gives $\|\mathsf{W}\|_+ \leq C_s(G)(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max}\beta_\lambda) = O(\|G\|^3 \bar{\theta}_G)$. □

The Rees and sliding-factor coordinates are classical; their combination with owner-wise block shortening is the quantitative step. For window and window–group typings the quadratic bounds of Theorems 4.9 and 4.10 are sharper.

The algebraic boundary for full refinement thickness. Put $\theta_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s) := \max\{1, \theta_{\widetilde{G_0}}\}$. For $f \geq 1$, a pseudovariety $\mathbf{V}$ has *polynomial refinement thickness at fan-out f* if for every nonempty finite Σ, every $r_{\max} \geq 1$ and every surjective $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$ with $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{V}$ there is a polynomial $q = q_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}$ such that every reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r_{\max}$ grammar G over Σ satisfies $\theta_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s) \leq q(\|G\|, \bar{\theta}_G)$.

Corollary 4.16 (Refinement-thickness dichotomy)**.** *For every $f \geq 1$ and every pseudovariety $\mathbf{V}$ of finite semigroups, $\mathbf{V}$ has polynomial refinement thickness at fan-out f if and only if $\mathbf{V} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$; for $\mathbf{V} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$ one may take $\theta_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s) = O_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$. The equivalence persists if G ranges only over presentations of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ with $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. For each single typing with $\mathsf{S} \notin \mathbf{LG}$ the polynomial bound already fails at fan-out one and rule rank two.*

Proof. If $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}$, the proof of Theorem 4.15 gives $(\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta})$ with $\beta_\lambda = O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$, and Lemma 4.2(i),(iii), which do not use substitutability, give $\theta_{\widetilde{G_0}} \leq 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max}\beta_\lambda$.

If $\mathsf{S} \notin \mathbf{LG}$, Theorem B.4(ii) gives a subsemigroup $\{e,z\} \cong U_1$: idempotents $e \neq z$ with $ez = ze = z$. By surjectivity choose $u, v \in \Sigma^+$ with $s(u) = e$, $s(v) = z$. Proposition 4.4(a) gives fan-out-one, rank-two grammars G_n with $\|G_n\| = O(n)$, $\bar{\theta}_{G_n} = O(1)$ and $\theta_{\mathrm{typ}}(G_n, s) \geq 2^n$; they present $\Sigma^+ = \widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{S}) \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. Finally, if $\mathbf{V} \not\subseteq \mathbf{LG}$, pick $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{V} \setminus \mathbf{LG}$; it is the positive image of the evaluation typing $\mathsf{S}^+ \to \mathsf{S}$ over the alphabet $\Sigma := \mathsf{S}$. □

Remark 4.17 (Refinement thickness is not a data lower bound). The corollary concerns one particular refinement, not the minimal encoded length of characteristic data and not arbitrary learners; its negative direction uses rank two. Polynomial refinement thickness yields polynomial data (Lemma 4.3), but not conversely: short distributional representatives may exist although the refinement is exponentially thick (Proposition 5.3). Whether $\mathbf{LG}$ is necessary for polynomial characteristic data at fan-out ≥ 2 is open (Open Problem 7.1).

4.6 Unrestricted Standard Input MCFGs

The input grammar need not be good: deleting, permuting and merging rules and empty components are all allowed. What then matters is the cost of realizing each nonempty-component pattern.

Definition 4.18 (Component-pattern thickness)**.** For a productive nonterminal A of a standard MCFG H let $\mathrm{supp}(\vec{u}) := \{i : u_i \neq \varepsilon\}$ and $\mathsf{Pat}_H(A) := \{\mathrm{supp}(\vec{u}) : \vec{u} \in L_A(H)\}$. Put

$$t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H) := \max_{\substack{A \text{ productive} \\ I \in \mathsf{Pat}_H(A)}} \min_{\substack{\vec{u} \in L_A(H) \\ \mathrm{supp}(\vec{u}) = I}} \|\vec{u}\|_1, \qquad \bar{t}_{\mathrm{pat}}(H) := \max\{1, t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H)\},$$

with $\max \emptyset := 0$. If H is reduced and λ-free, only the full pattern occurs and $t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H) = t_H$.

Proposition 4.19 (Good normalization controlled by pattern thickness)**.** *Let H be a standard fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r$ MCFG with $L(H) \cap \Sigma^+ \neq \emptyset$, and H_{red} its trimmed form. There is a reduced good MCFG G for $L(H) \cap \Sigma^+$ with the same fan-out and rank bounds and*

$$\|G\| = O_{f,r}(\|H\|), \qquad t_G \leq t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}}), \qquad \bar{\theta}_G = O_{f,r}\big(\|H\|\, \bar{t}_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})\big).$$

Proof. Take G from Proposition 3.12. By Lemma F.1, each nonterminal language of G is an image of a union of support-pattern fibres of H_{red} under component deletion, permutation and concatenation, which do not increase total length; so $t_G \le t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$ (Appendix C). Lemma 4.1(iii) gives the bound on $\bar{\theta}_G$. □

Corollary 4.20 (Total characteristic-data length from any standard MCFG)**.** *Let H be any finite standard fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r$ MCFG for $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$; put $n := \max\{1, \|H\|\}$ and $t := \bar{t}_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$. The operator $\mathcal{B}^{\le r}_{f,s}$ has a characteristic sample $K \subseteq L$ with $|K| = O(n)$ and*

$$\|K\|_+ = \begin{cases} O(n^3 t), & \text{if } \widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g) \text{ for some } k, \ell \text{ and finite-group morphism } g \text{ (possibly trivial)}, \\ O(n^4 t), & \text{if } \mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}, \end{cases}$$

with constants depending on f, r, s, Σ (and k, ℓ, g), not on H.

Proof. If $L \subseteq \{\varepsilon\}$ take $K = L$. Otherwise Proposition 4.19 gives G with $\|G\| = O(n)$ and $\bar{\theta}_G = O(nt)$; apply Theorem 4.10 or Theorem 4.15. □

5 Further Quantitative Results

This section gives three results that complement Section 4 and are not used there: a bound in grammar size alone for rank one under every typing (Section 5.1); polynomial-time computation of the short witness sets together with a computable data budget (Section 5.2); and characteristic samples from short *distributional* representatives, which yield polynomial data for abelian-filtered targets under every typing (Section 5.3). Notation is that of Section 4; in particular $C_s(G) = |V||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f + |P||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}} \le |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}} \|G\|$.

5.1 Rule Rank One

Theorem 5.1 (Rank-one characteristic-data bound)**.** *Fix f and a typing s.*

(i) *If G is a reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-≤ 1 presentation of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ with $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, then $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}^{\le 1}_{f,s}$ and*

$$\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f (3 + |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f) \|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G \le 2|\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f (3 + |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f) \|G\|^3.$$

(ii) *For any standard fan-out-$\le f$, rank-≤ 1 grammar G_{in} for $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, the operator $\mathcal{B}^{\le 1}_{f,s}$ has a characteristic sample K with $\|K\|_+ = O_{f,s}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|^3)$.*

Proof. (i) A terminal derivation in a rank-≤ 1 grammar is a chain of unary rules ending in a constant rule. In a shortest chain no nonterminal repeats (splicing out the segment between two occurrences does not lengthen the yield, by linearity), so its rules are distinct. Hence $t_G \le \|G\|$, and the proof of Lemma 4.1(iii), whose path rules together with R are distinct and whose child chain is distinct, gives $\theta_G \le 2\|G\|$, so $\bar{\theta}_G \le 2\|G\|$. In $\widetilde{G}_0$, which also has rank ≤ 1, a shortest chain from a typed nonterminal X repeats no typed nonterminal, so it has at most $|V||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f$ rules, each writing at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ letters (Lemma 4.1(i)). So $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le b := |V||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f \bar{\theta}_G$ for suitable canonical tuples. Lemma 4.2(ii),(iv) with $r_{\max} = 1$ gives the sample and $\|\mathsf{W}\|_+ \le C_s(G)(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + b)$; use $C_s(G) \le |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f \|G\|$, $1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G \le 3\bar{\theta}_G$ and $|V| \le \|G\|$.

(ii) If $L \subseteq \{\varepsilon\}$ take $K = L$. Otherwise Proposition 3.12 gives a reduced good rank-≤ 1 presentation G of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ with $\|G\| = O_f(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$; apply (i). □

No thickness parameter is needed at rank one, and the typing affects only the constant; this extends the rank-one untyped scale [14, Lemma 7]. Rank two needs thickness: the size-$O(n)$ grammar $S \to A_n$, $A_i \to A_{i-1}A_{i-1}$, $A_0 \to \mathsf{c}$ generates $\{\mathsf{c}^{2^n}\}$, which lies in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ for every f and s (over one letter, a shared sentence context forces equal total component length, hence equal distributions), and every characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ contains c^{2^n}, because it is a nonempty subset of the target ($L(\mathcal{B}(\emptyset)) = \emptyset$).

5.2 Computing Short Characteristic Data

Let G be reduced and good of fan-out $\le f$ and rank $\le r_{\max}$. For a typed rule $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$ let c_R be the number of terminals written by ρ and $\operatorname{lhs} R := X$; let $\mathcal{R}$ be the set of typed rules of $\widetilde{G}_0$ (rank zero included). Put

$$\ell_{\mathrm{in}}(X) := \min_{\vec{u} \in L_X} \|\vec{u}\|_1, \qquad \ell_{\mathrm{out}}(X) := \min\{|\chi|_{\mathrm{fix}} : \chi \text{ derivational for } X\},$$

(derivational as in Lemma 4.1(iv); so $\ell_{\mathrm{out}}(X) = 0$ if $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is a rule), and

$$b(R) := c_R + \sum_{j=1}^{q} \ell_{\mathrm{in}}(Y_j), \qquad \mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G, s) := \sum_{R \in \mathcal{R}} \big(1 + \ell_{\mathrm{out}}(\operatorname{lhs} R) + b(R)\big).$$

Proposition 5.2 (Effective short characteristic data and a rule-only budget)**.** *Fix f, $r_{\max}$ and s. Given G, the following are computable in time polynomial in $\|G\|$, numbers being written in binary.*

(i) *$\widetilde{G}_0$, all values $\ell_{\mathrm{in}}(X)$, $\ell_{\mathrm{out}}(X)$ and $\mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G, s)$, and $\theta_G(R)$ for every rule R of G (hence θ_G and t_G).*

(ii) *For each typed nonterminal X, a rule $R_X : X \to \rho_X(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$ such that the recursion $\omega(X) := \rho_X(\omega(Y_1), \dots, \omega(Y_q))$ is well-founded and gives $\omega(X) \in L_X$ with $\|\omega(X)\|_1 = \ell_{\mathrm{in}}(X)$; and a derivational context $\chi(X)$ with $|\chi(X)|_{\mathrm{fix}} = \ell_{\mathrm{out}}(X)$, equal to $\Box_1$ whenever $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is a rule. Both are given by derivation DAGs of size polynomial in $\|G\|$.*

For these choices,

$$\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) = \{\chi(\operatorname{lhs} R)[\rho_R(\omega(Y_1), \dots, \omega(Y_q))] : R \in \mathcal{R}\},$$
$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \le |\mathcal{R}|, \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le \mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G, s),$$

the words can be written out in time polynomial in $\|G\| + \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+$, and every bound on $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ proved in Sections 4.1–4.5, Section 5.1 and Appendix B holds for this set; in particular it is characteristic whenever $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$ with $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$.

Proof. For fixed $f, r_{\max}, s$ the full refinement has $O(C_s(G))$ symbols and rules, and trimming is a linear-time productivity and reachability computation.

Inside values. Give a derivation the weight (terminal length, number of nodes), ordered lexicographically. A rule R maps child weights (x_j, n_j) to $(c_R, 1) + \sum_j (x_j, n_j)$, which is strictly larger than every argument. Knuth's generalization of Dijkstra's algorithm, in Nederhof's weighted-deduction form [35] (see also [34]), therefore computes the minimum weight of every typed nonterminal together with a minimizing rule R_X whose children are finalized before X. This order makes the recursion for ω well-founded, the chosen rules form a DAG, and the first coordinate of the weight is $\ell_{\mathrm{in}}(X) = \|\omega(X)\|_1$.

Outside values. Run Dijkstra's algorithm on the graph with an edge $X \to Y_j$ of weight $c_R + \sum_{i \ne j} \ell_{\mathrm{in}}(Y_i)$ for every typed rule $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$, from the sources X with $\widetilde{S} \to X$ at

distance 0. A path from a source to X yields, by composing its templates and filling the siblings with $\omega(Y_i)$, a context of X of that fixed length; it is admissible by Lemma 3.1 and derivational because it arises from a successful derivation by deleting the X-subtree. Conversely every derivational context of X comes from a root-to-X path whose siblings have yields at least ℓ_{in}. Hence the distance is $\ell_{\mathrm{out}}(X)$, and the shortest-path tree with the inside DAG represents $\chi(X)$. The same two passes on G give $t_G = \max_A \ell_{\mathrm{in}}(A)$ and $\theta_G(R) = \ell_{\mathrm{out}}(A) + c_R + \sum_j \ell_{\mathrm{in}}(B_j)$ for $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_q)$, since outside and inside parts of a derivation can be chosen independently. All values are at most exponential in $\|G\|$, so have polynomial binary length.

Witness set and budget. By definition of ω, $\chi(X)[\omega(X)]$ is the rule word of R_X, and every other word of Definition 3.9 is a rule word. The rule word of R has length exactly $\ell_{\mathrm{out}}(\mathrm{lhs}\, R) + b(R)$; summing $|w| + 1$ over $\mathcal{R}$ gives $\mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}$, and passing to distinct words can only lower it. Expanding a DAG takes time linear in the length of the word it represents.

Inherited bounds. Each cited bound is proved by exhibiting *some* $\omega(X) \in L_X$ and the derivational context E_B (Lemma 4.1(iv)); the computed minima are no longer and the number of words is unchanged. The characteristic property is Lemma 4.2(iv). □

The budget $\mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}$ is a presentation-sensitive *upper certificate*, often far below the worst-case bounds; it is not the size of a minimum characteristic sample. For $\{\mathsf{c}^{2^n}\}$ of Section 5.1 the words are exponentially longer than $\|G\|$, but their DAGs have polynomial size.

5.3 Distributional Representatives and Abelian-Filtered Targets

Proposition 3.11 does not require a representative to be derivable from its nonterminal. One may therefore use the shortest member of the whole typed distribution class. Let G be a reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r$ presentation of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ with $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. For a typed nonterminal X let $[X]$ be the $\equiv_{L,s}$-class containing L_X (Lemma 3.8) and put

$$\kappa_G(X) := \min_{\vec{v} \in [X]} \|\vec{v}\|_1 \le \ell_{\mathrm{in}}(X), \qquad \kappa_G := \max_X \kappa_G(X).$$

Proposition 5.3 (Relaxed distributional witnesses)**.** *For each typed nonterminal $X = B_{\mathbf{t}}$ choose $\iota(X) \in [X]$ with $\|\iota(X)\|_1 = \kappa_G(X)$ and put $\chi(X) := E_B$ (Lemma 4.1(iv)). The words $\chi(X)[\iota(X)]$ and $\chi(X)[\rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_q))]$, over all typed nonterminals and typed rules $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$, form a set $K^\dagger \subseteq L$ such that $K^\dagger \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is characteristic for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r}_{f,s}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$, and*

$$|K^\dagger| \le C_s(G), \qquad \|K^\dagger\|_+ \le C_s(G)(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r\kappa_G).$$

Proof. Fix $\vec{u}_X \in L_X$ for every X. Since $\iota(X) \equiv_{L,s} \vec{u}_X$ and E_B accepts $\vec{u}_X$, it accepts $\iota(X)$; so $\chi(X)[\iota(X)] \in L$. By Lemma 3.2, $\rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_q)) \equiv_{L,s} \rho(\vec{u}_{Y_1}, \ldots, \vec{u}_{Y_q}) \in L_X$, so the rule words also lie in L. Each $\iota(X)$ has $\widehat{s}$-vector $\mathbf{t}$, nonempty components, and $\chi(S_{\mathbf{t}}) = E_S = \Box_1$, so Proposition 3.11 applies with this ι and gives $L \cap \Sigma^+ \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}(K))$ for $K \supseteq K^\dagger$; Proposition 3.10 gives the converse for $K \subseteq L$, and the Start rule handles ε. The length bound is Lemma 4.2(ii) with $b = \kappa_G$, whose proof uses only $\|\iota(X)\|_1 \le b$. □

Unlike Proposition 5.2, the words $\chi(X)[\iota(X)]$ cannot in general be omitted. For fixed f, r, s, a family G_n with $\|G_n\|\bar{\theta}_{G_n} = n^{O(1)}$ that requires superpolynomial characteristic data must therefore have $\kappa_{G_n} = n^{\omega(1)}$; this is a necessary condition, not a proof that such a family exists.

Theorem 5.4 (Polynomial data for abelian-filtered targets)**.** *Fix a nonempty alphabet Σ, a typing s and $f, r \ge 1$. There is a constant C depending only on Σ, s, f, r such that the following holds*

for every abelian group A*, morphism* $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{A}$*, subgroup* $\mathsf{H} \leq \mathsf{A}$*,* $\gamma \in \mathsf{A}$ *and* $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq \mathsf{S}^\sharp$*. If* $L := \widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$ *and* $L \cap \Sigma^+$ *has a reduced good fan-out-*$\leq f$*, rank-*$\leq r$ *presentation* G*, then* $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ *and* $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r}_{f,s}$ *has a characteristic sample* K *with*

$$\|K\|_+ \leq C\,(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)^{3|\Sigma|+2}.$$

Proof. $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ by Proposition 2.9. By Proposition 5.3 and $C_s(G) \leq |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{fr}\|G\|$ it suffices to show $\kappa_G \leq C'(T+1)^{3|\Sigma|+1}$ with $T := (r+1)t_G + \|G\| \leq (r+2)\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G$ and C' depending only on Σ, s, f.

A lattice of admissible Parikh shifts. Let ψ be the Parikh map, $\Psi(\vec{u}) := \sum_i \psi(u_i)$, and $\overline{\varphi} : \mathbb{Z}^\Sigma \to \mathsf{A}$ the homomorphism with $\varphi = \overline{\varphi} \circ \psi$; put $\Lambda := \overline{\varphi}^{-1}(\mathsf{H})$. For each $C \in V$ fix $\omega_C \in L_C(G)$ with $\|\omega_C\|_1 \leq t_G$. For $\vec{u} \in L_C(G)$ the context E_C accepts $\vec{u}$ and ω_C, and $L \subseteq \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$, so

$$\Psi(\vec{u}) - \Psi(\omega_C) \in \Lambda. \qquad (*)$$

For a rule $R : C \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_q)$ let $c_R \in \mathbb{N}^\Sigma$ count its letters and $\delta_R := \Psi(\omega_C) - c_R - \sum_j \Psi(\omega_{B_j})$. Applying $(*)$ to $\rho(\omega_{B_1}, \ldots, \omega_{B_q})$ gives $\delta_R \in \Lambda$, and $\|\delta_R\|_1 \leq T$. Let $\Gamma_T := \{z \in \Lambda : \|z\|_1 \leq T\}$ and $\Lambda_T := \langle \Gamma_T \rangle$. For $\vec{u} = \rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_q)$ with $\vec{u}_j \in L_{B_j}(G)$, $\Psi(\vec{u}) - \Psi(\omega_C) = \sum_j (\Psi(\vec{u}_j) - \Psi(\omega_{B_j})) - \delta_R$, so induction on derivations gives $\Psi(\vec{u}) - \Psi(\omega_C) \in \Lambda_T$ for all $\vec{u} \in L_C(G)$.

A short representative. Let $X = C_{\mathbf{t}}$ have arity $d \leq f$ and $\vec{u} \in L_X$. For each i fix, once and for all, a semilinear representation of the Parikh image of the regular language $\widehat{s}^{-1}(t_i) \cap \Sigma^+$, and choose a linear set $c_i + \sum_{p \in P_i} \mathbb{N}p$ of it containing $\psi(u_i)$; the number and size of these generators depend only on Σ and s. Write $\Psi(\vec{u}) - \Psi(\omega_C) = \sum_{z \in \Gamma_T} m_z z$ with $m_z \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then the system

$$\sum_{i=1}^{d} \sum_{p \in P_i} \eta_{i,p}\, p - \sum_{z \in \Gamma_T} (\mu_z^+ - \mu_z^-)\, z = \Psi(\omega_C) - \sum_{i=1}^{d} c_i$$

has a solution in nonnegative integers (the coefficients of $\psi(u_i)$ and $\mu_z^\pm := \max\{\pm m_z, 0\}$). It has $m = |\Sigma|$ equations, $n \leq D + 2(2T+1)^{|\Sigma|}$ unknowns and entries of absolute value at most $a \leq D(T+1)$, with D depending only on Σ, s, f. By Papadimitriou's bound [39] it has a nonnegative integer solution with all entries at most $n(ma)^{2m+1} = O\big((T+1)^{3|\Sigma|+1}\big)$. For each i the vector $c_i + \sum_p \eta_{i,p} p$ is the Parikh vector of some nonempty $v_i \in \widehat{s}^{-1}(t_i)$; put $\vec{v} := (v_1, \ldots, v_d)$. Then $\|\vec{v}\|_1 = O((T+1)^{3|\Sigma|+1})$, $\widehat{s}^{(d)}(\vec{v}) = \mathbf{t}$, and $\Psi(\vec{v}) - \Psi(\vec{u}) \in \Lambda_T \subseteq \Lambda$. For every admissible E, $E[\vec{v}]$ and $E[\vec{u}]$ have the same $\widehat{s}$-value, and $\varphi(E[\vec{v}]) - \varphi(E[\vec{u}]) = \overline{\varphi}(\Psi(\vec{v}) - \Psi(\vec{u})) \in \mathsf{H}$; so $E[\vec{v}] \in L$ iff $E[\vec{u}] \in L$, i.e. $\vec{v} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{u}$ and $\kappa_G(X) \leq \|\vec{v}\|_1$. □

The theorem holds even when $\mathsf{S} \notin \mathbf{LG}$: its hypothesis concerns the target, not the typing. It is not a bound for all of $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, the representation of L is not supplied to the learner, and no polynomial-time construction is claimed for ineffectively presented groups A.

6 Comparison with Multidimensional Substitutability

Yoshinaka's multidimensional substitutability [13, 14] is the direct positive-data baseline. This section shows that (i) trivial typing recovers it and window typing recovers the CFG (k, ℓ) hierarchy of [12], while a fixed finite typing admits non-context-free targets outside the baseline (Section 6.1); (ii) the algebraic regimes of Section 4 are separated at the level of targets (Section 6.2); and (iii) a boundary-typed target can require rule rank two at every finite fan-out (Section 6.3). Since every (f, s) condition includes arity one, $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s} \cap \mathrm{CFL} \subseteq \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s}$.

6.1 Yoshinaka's Baseline and Finite Feature Licensing

Definition 6.1 (Multidimensional substitutability)**.** A language L is *fD-substitutable* if for every $1 \le d \le f$, all $E, F \in \mathcal{E}_d$ and all $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$, $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}], F[\vec{x}] \in L \Rightarrow F[\vec{y}] \in L$ (the *substitution implication*); $\mathsf{YSub}(f)$ is the class of these languages. This is Yoshinaka's definition, with nonempty components and nonempty internal separators [14, Section 3.1 and footnote 3].

The substitution implication is (f, s_{triv})-tuple substitutability, so $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}} = \mathsf{YSub}(f) \cap f\text{-MCFL} \subseteq \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ for every s. Yoshinaka's word-level (k, ℓ) condition [12] requires, for $u \in \Sigma^k$, $v \in \Sigma^\ell$ and nonempty uy_1v, uy_2v, that $w_1uy_1vw_1', w_1uy_2vw_1' \in L$ imply $w_2uy_1vw_2' \in L \iff w_2uy_2vw_2' \in L$. Two nonempty words have equal $s_{k,\ell}$-type iff they are identical or both have length at least $\max\{1, k+\ell\}$ with the same first k and last ℓ letters, i.e. iff they are of the forms uy_1v, uy_2v above (or equal). Hence $(1, s_{k,\ell})$-tuple substitutability is exactly Yoshinaka's (k, ℓ) condition; the componentwise version at higher fan-out is a definition of this paper.

A language L is *strictly 2-local* if there is a set Π of pairs over $\Sigma \cup \{\vdash, \dashv\}$ such that a word w lies in L iff every pair of adjacent symbols of $\vdash w \dashv$ lies in Π.

Lemma 6.2 (Strictly 2-local languages are boundary typed)**.** *Every strictly 2-local L is $(f, s_{1,1})$-tuple-substitutable for every f; in particular $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{1,1}}$, and $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ whenever $s_{1,1} \preceq s$.*

Proof. Let $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ have equal $s_{1,1}$-types, so corresponding components are identical letters or share first and last letters, and let $E_0[\vec{x}], E_0[\vec{y}] \in L$. Suppose $E[\vec{x}] \in L$. Since the internal separators of E are nonempty, every adjacent pair of $\vdash E[\vec{y}] \dashv$ either lies inside some y_i, and then occurs in $E_0[\vec{y}] \in L$, or joins a first or last letter of some y_i to a symbol of $\vdash E \dashv$, or lies in $\vdash E \dashv$, and then occurs in $\vdash E[\vec{x}] \dashv$. So $E[\vec{y}] \in L$; symmetry and $s_{1,1} \preceq s$ finish the proof (regular languages are MCFLs). □

Proposition 6.3 (Cross-serial dependencies with finite feature licensing)**.** *Let* $\Sigma_{\mathrm{feat}} = \{\mathtt{p}_0, \mathtt{p}_1, \mathtt{q}_0, \mathtt{q}_1, \mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d}\}$, $\mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{feat}} = \{(0,0), (0,1), (1,0)\}$, *and*

$$L_{\mathrm{feat}} = \{\mathtt{a}^m \mathtt{p}_i \mathtt{b}^n \mathtt{c}^m \mathtt{q}_j \mathtt{d}^n : m, n \ge 1,\ (i,j) \in \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{feat}}\}.$$

Let $g : \Sigma^*_{\mathrm{feat}} \to \mathbb{Z}_2^2$ map $\mathtt{p}_1 \mapsto (1,0)$, $\mathtt{q}_1 \mapsto (0,1)$ and all other letters to 0, and let $s := (s_{1,1}, g)|_{\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{feat}}}$ (corestricted to its image). Then $L_{\mathrm{feat}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(2,2) \setminus \mathrm{CFL}$ and $L_{\mathrm{feat}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s} \setminus \mathsf{YSub}(f)$ for every $f \ge 2$; moreover L_{feat} is not $(1, s_{1,1})$-tuple-substitutable.

Proof. Grammar. With fan-out-two A, B and rules $A \to (\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}) \mid (\mathtt{a}\xi^1_1, \mathtt{c}\xi^2_1)(A)$, $B \to (\mathtt{b}, \mathtt{d}) \mid (\mathtt{b}\xi^1_1, \mathtt{d}\xi^2_1)(B)$ and $S \to (\xi^1_1 \mathtt{p}_i \xi^1_2 \xi^2_1 \mathtt{q}_j \xi^2_2)(A, B)$ for $(i,j) \in \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{feat}}$, we get $L_A = \{(\mathtt{a}^m, \mathtt{c}^m)\}$, $L_B = \{(\mathtt{b}^n, \mathtt{d}^n)\}$ and $L(G) = L_{\mathrm{feat}}$; the grammar is good, of fan-out and rank two. Intersecting with $\mathtt{a}^+\mathtt{p}_0\mathtt{b}^+\mathtt{c}^+\mathtt{q}_0\mathtt{d}^+$ and erasing the markers gives the classical non-context-free $\{\mathtt{a}^m\mathtt{b}^n\mathtt{c}^m\mathtt{d}^n\}$.

Typed substitutability. Let $Q = \mathtt{a}^+\{\mathtt{p}_0, \mathtt{p}_1\}\mathtt{b}^+\mathtt{c}^+\{\mathtt{q}_0, \mathtt{q}_1\}\mathtt{d}^+$ (strictly 2-local), $K_{\mathrm{feat}} := \{w \in \Sigma^+_{\mathrm{feat}} : g(w) \in \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{feat}}\}$, and let φ map $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{d}$ to $(1,0), (-1,0), (0,1), (0,-1) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ and the markers to 0. On Q, $g(w) = (i,j)$ for the markers $\mathtt{p}_i, \mathtt{q}_j$ of w, so $L_{\mathrm{feat}} = Q \cap K_{\mathrm{feat}} \cap \varphi^{-1}(0)$. The three languages are (f,s)-tuple-substitutable by Lemma 6.2, by item (c) after Definition 2.8 (K_{feat} is a union of s-classes), and by Proposition 2.9(ii); Proposition 2.9(i) gives the intersection.

Failure without g. For $x = \mathtt{ap}_0\mathtt{b}$, $y = \mathtt{ap}_1\mathtt{b}$, $E = \square_1\mathtt{cq}_0\mathtt{d}$ and $F = \square_1\mathtt{cq}_1\mathtt{d}$ we have $E[x], E[y], F[x] \in L_{\mathrm{feat}}$ but $F[y] \notin L_{\mathrm{feat}}$, since $(1,1) \notin \mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{feat}}$. Here $s_{1,1}(x) = s_{1,1}(y)$ but $g(x) \ne g(y)$. □

Corollary 6.4 (Uniform finite feature licensing)**.** *With the* same *typing s, for every $R \subseteq \{0,1\}^2$ the language $L_R := \{\mathtt{a}^m\mathtt{p}_i\mathtt{b}^n\mathtt{c}^m\mathtt{q}_j\mathtt{d}^n : m,n \geq 1,\ (i,j) \in R\}$ lies in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ for all $f \geq 2$, and for $R \neq \emptyset$ it is not context-free. The typing is fixed once for the whole family; the same holds for any fixed inventories $\{0,\dots,p-1\} \times \{0,\dots,q-1\}$ with g into $\mathbb{Z}_p \times \mathbb{Z}_q$.*

Proof. Keep the start rules indexed by R, replace $\mathcal{R}_{\mathrm{feat}}$ by R in K_{feat} (still a union of s-classes), and repeat the proof; for $(i,j) \in R$ use $\mathtt{a}^+\mathtt{p}_i\mathtt{b}^+\mathtt{c}^+\mathtt{q}_j\mathtt{d}^+$ for non-context-freeness. □

Proposition 6.5 (Explicit data budget for a common feature typing)**.** *Let $f \geq 2$ and $R \neq \emptyset$. The operator $\mathcal{B}^{\leq 2}_{f,s}$ has a characteristic sample $K_R \subseteq L_R$ with $\|K_R\|_+ = 36|R| + 22$ (for $R = \emptyset$ the empty sample is characteristic). Conversely, if a set-driven operator $\mathcal{D}$ has characteristic samples for* all *$L_{R'}$, $R' \subseteq \{0,1\}^2$, then every characteristic sample K for L_R under $\mathcal{D}$ contains a word with markers $\mathtt{p}_i, \mathtt{q}_j$ for each $(i,j) \in R$; hence $\|K\|_+ \geq 7|R|$.*

Proof. Write $w^{m,n}_{ij} := \mathtt{a}^m\mathtt{p}_i\mathtt{b}^n\mathtt{c}^m\mathtt{q}_j\mathtt{d}^n$, of length $2m + 2n + 2$, fix $(i_0, j_0) \in R$, and let

$$K_R := \{w^{m,n}_{ij} : (i,j) \in R,\ m,n \in \{1,2\}\} \cup \{w^{3,1}_{i_0j_0}, w^{1,3}_{i_0j_0}\}.$$

The encoded costs are $7 + 9 + 9 + 11 = 36$ per pair and $11 + 11$ for the two extra words.

Typed refinement. For the grammar G of Proposition 6.3 with start rules indexed by R, the s-type of $(\mathtt{a}^m, \mathtt{c}^m)$ depends only on whether $m = 1$ (short words are recorded exactly), so A has two typed copies A_1, A_+, and likewise B_1, B_+; the type of $w^{m,n}_{ij}$ is determined by (i,j), giving one typed start nonterminal S_{ij} per $(i,j) \in R$. With $\rho_A := (\mathtt{a}\xi^1_1, \mathtt{c}\xi^2_1)$, the typed rules are $A_1 \to (\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c})$, $A_+ \to \rho_A(A_1)$, $A_+ \to \rho_A(A_+)$, their B-analogues, and four start rules $S_{ij} \to \rho_{ij}(A_\bullet, B_\circ)$ per $(i,j) \in R$.

Witnesses. Take $\iota(A_1) = (\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c})$, $\iota(A_+) = (\mathtt{a}^2, \mathtt{c}^2)$, $\iota(B_1) = (\mathtt{b}, \mathtt{d})$, $\iota(B_+) = (\mathtt{b}^2, \mathtt{d}^2)$, $\iota(S_{ij}) = w^{1,1}_{ij}$, the contexts $\chi(A_\bullet) = \Box_1\mathtt{p}_{i_0}\mathtt{b}\Box_2\mathtt{q}_{j_0}\mathtt{d}$, $\chi(B_\circ) = \mathtt{a}\mathtt{p}_{i_0}\Box_1\mathtt{c}\mathtt{q}_{j_0}\Box_2$ and $\chi(S_{ij}) = \Box_1$. The required words of Proposition 3.11 are: $w^{1,1}_{i_0j_0}$ for A_1, B_1 and their constant rules; $w^{2,1}_{i_0j_0}$ and $w^{1,2}_{i_0j_0}$ for A_+, B_+ and the rules from A_1, B_1; $w^{3,1}_{i_0j_0}$ and $w^{1,3}_{i_0j_0}$ for the rules from A_+, B_+; and $w^{m,n}_{ij}$, $m,n \in \{1,2\}$, for S_{ij} and its four rules. All lie in K_R. Since $K_R \subseteq L_R \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, Propositions 3.11 and 3.10 make K_R characteristic for $\mathcal{B}^{\leq 2}_{f,s}$.

Lower bound. If K contains no word with markers $\mathtt{p}_i, \mathtt{q}_j$, then $K \subseteq L_{R'}$ for $R' = R \setminus \{(i,j)\}$. For a characteristic sample F of $L_{R'}$, the set $K \cup F$ lies between K and L_R and between F and $L_{R'}$, so $L(\mathcal{D}(K \cup F))$ would equal both $L_R \neq L_{R'}$. Distinct pairs need distinct words, each of length at least 6. □

The example models a finite case-licensing or feature-compatibility constraint; no claim about a specific natural language is made. The relation R varies with the target, while the morphism g and the operator do not.

6.2 Separating the Typing Classes

The feature example is covered by a window and an abelian group. Two further fan-out-two targets separate the regimes of Section 4: L_{A} is admitted by a local-group typing but by no window–group-determined typing, and L_{B} by a window–S_3 typing but by no window–abelian one. Both have the form $\sigma w\$c$: a flag $\sigma = \mathtt{r}$ leaves w unconstrained, $\sigma = \mathtt{l}$ imposes a typing-dependent condition on w, and $c \in C_\times := \{\mathtt{1}^m\mathtt{2}^n\mathtt{3}^m\mathtt{4}^n : m,n \geq 1\}$ makes the target non-context-free. Let $\varphi_\times$ map $\mathtt{1},\mathtt{3},\mathtt{2},\mathtt{4}$ to $(1,0),(-1,0),(0,1),(0,-1) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ and all other letters to 0, and let $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w)$ be the number of occurrences of the factor $\mathtt{ab}$ in w.

Lemma 6.6 (Flag separation)**.** *Let t be a typing, $u, v \in \Sigma^+$ with $t(u) = t(v)$, and $z \in \Sigma^*$. If L contains $\mathtt{r}uz$, $\mathtt{r}vz$ and $\mathtt{l}uz$ but not $\mathtt{l}vz$, then $L \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,t}$ for every $f \geq 1$.*

Proof. $\mathtt{r}\Box_1 z \in \mathcal{E}_1$ accepts u and v, while $\mathtt{l}\Box_1 z$ accepts u but not v; so $\mathcal{D}^{(1)}_L(u) \neq \mathcal{D}^{(1)}_L(v)$, and every (f,t) condition includes arity one. □

The targets. Let $\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}} = \{\mathtt{l}, \mathtt{r}, \mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}, \$, \mathtt{1}, \mathtt{2}, \mathtt{3}, \mathtt{4}\}$,

$$L_{\mathrm{A}} := \{\sigma w \$ c : \sigma \in \{\mathtt{l}, \mathtt{r}\},\ w \in \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}^+,\ c \in C_\times,\ \sigma = \mathtt{r} \text{ or } \#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w) \text{ even}\},$$

and $s_{\mathrm{A}} := \lambda_{1,\nu}|_{\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{A}}}$ with $\nu : \Sigma^2_{\mathrm{A}} \to \mathbb{Z}_2$, $\nu(\mathtt{ab}) = 1$ and $\nu = 0$ otherwise (Definition 4.14); it records the first and last letters and, for $|w| \geq 2$, the parity of $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w)$. Let $\Sigma_{\mathrm{B}} = \Sigma_{\mathrm{A}} \setminus \{\mathtt{c}\}$, $\alpha = (12)$, $\beta = (23) \in S_3$, $g_{\mathrm{B}} : \Sigma^*_{\mathrm{B}} \to S_3$ with $\mathtt{a} \mapsto \alpha$, $\mathtt{b} \mapsto \beta$ and all other letters $\mapsto 1$,

$$L_{\mathrm{B}} := \{\sigma w \$ c : \sigma \in \{\mathtt{l}, \mathtt{r}\},\ w \in \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}\}^+,\ c \in C_\times,\ \sigma = \mathtt{r} \text{ or } g_{\mathrm{B}}(w) = 1\},$$

and $s_{\mathrm{B}} := (s_{1,1}, g_{\mathrm{B}})|_{\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{B}}}$, corestricted. **Ab** is the pseudovariety of finite abelian groups, and $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Ab}$ consists of the divisors of $T \times A$ with $T \in \mathbf{LI}$ and A finite abelian.

Proposition 6.7 (A target separating local-group and window–group typings)**.** (i) $L_{\mathrm{A}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(2,2) \setminus \mathrm{CFL}$.

(ii) *$L_{\mathrm{A}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{A}}}$ for every $f \geq 2$, and $s_{\mathrm{A}}(\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{A}}) \in \mathbf{LG}$.*

(iii) *If $t \preceq (s_{k,\ell}, g'|_{\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{A}}})$ for some k, ℓ and a morphism g' into a finite group (in particular if $t(\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{A}}) \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$), then $L_{\mathrm{A}} \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,t}$ for all $f \geq 1$.*

Hence $s_{\mathrm{A}}(\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{A}}) \in \mathbf{LG} \setminus (\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp})$, and L_{A} is covered by Theorem 4.15 but, for no typing, by Theorems 4.9, 4.10, 4.11 or Corollary 4.13.

Proposition 6.8 (A target separating nonabelian and window–abelian typings)**.** (i) $L_{\mathrm{B}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(2,2) \setminus \mathrm{CFL}$.

(ii) *$L_{\mathrm{B}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{B}}}$ for every $f \geq 2$, and s_{B} is window–group-determined with group S_3.*

(iii) *If $t \preceq (s_{k,\ell}, g'|_{\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{B}}})$ for some k, ℓ and a morphism g' into a finite* abelian *group (in particular if $t(\Sigma^+_{\mathrm{B}}) \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Ab}$), then $L_{\mathrm{B}} \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,t}$ for all $f \geq 1$.*

Hence L_{B} is covered by Theorem 4.10 with the nonabelian constant $c_{S_3,f} = M_{S_3,f} - 1$, but for no typing by Theorem 4.9 or 4.11.

Proof of Propositions 6.7 and 6.8. Write $X \in \{\mathrm{A}, \mathrm{B}\}$, let Σ°_X be $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}$ or $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}\}$, and let $P_X(w)$ be "$\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w)$ even" or "$g_{\mathrm{B}}(w) = 1$".

(i) Let W be a right-linear (fan-out-one, rank-one, good) grammar for the regular language $\{\sigma w : \sigma \in \{\mathtt{l}, \mathtt{r}\}, w \in (\Sigma^\circ_X)^+, \sigma = \mathtt{r} \text{ or } P_X(w)\}$; it tracks the last letter and the parity, respectively the value in S_3. Add

$$C \to (\xi^1_1 \$ \mathtt{1}, \mathtt{3})(W) \mid (\xi^1_1 \mathtt{1}, \xi^2_1 \mathtt{3})(C), \quad D \to (\mathtt{2}, \mathtt{4}) \mid (\xi^1_1 \mathtt{2}, \xi^2_1 \mathtt{4})(D), \quad S \to (\xi^1_1 \xi^1_2 \xi^2_1 \xi^2_2)(C, D).$$

Then $L_C = \{(\sigma w \$ \mathtt{1}^m, \mathtt{3}^m)\}$, $L_D = \{(\mathtt{2}^n, \mathtt{4}^n)\}$, and S generates L_X; the grammar is good (adjacent variables in the start template belong to different children). Intersecting with $\mathtt{ra}\$\mathtt{1}^+\mathtt{2}^+\mathtt{3}^+\mathtt{4}^+$ and erasing $\mathtt{ra}\$$ gives the non-context-free $C_\times$.

(ii) $L_X = Q_X \cap \Pi_X \cap \varphi_\times^{-1}(0)$ with $Q_X = \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\}(\Sigma_X^\circ)^+\$\mathtt{1}^+\mathtt{2}^+\mathtt{3}^+\mathtt{4}^+$ and Π_X the set of nonempty words that begin with $\mathtt{r}$, or begin with $\mathtt{l}$ and satisfy P_X for the whole word. On Q_X the condition P_X of the whole word is that of w: no factor $\mathtt{ab}$ meets σ, \$ or the digits, and g_{B} is trivial on all other letters. Q_X is strictly 2-local (its pairs are $\vdash\sigma$, σx, xy, $x\$$, $\$\mathtt{1}$, $\mathtt{11},\mathtt{12},\mathtt{22},\mathtt{23},\mathtt{33},\mathtt{34},\mathtt{44}$, $\mathtt{4}\dashv$ for $\sigma\in\{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\}$, $x,y\in\Sigma_X^\circ$) and $s_{1,1}\preceq s_X$, so Lemma 6.2 applies. Π_X is a union of s_X-classes: s_X records the first letter, and for words of length at least two the parity of $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}$, respectively the value of g_{B} (the one-letter words $\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}$ lie in Π_X); so item (c) after Definition 2.8 applies. Proposition 2.9 handles $\varphi_\times^{-1}(0)$ and the intersection; with (i), $L_X\in\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_X}$ for $f\ge 2$. s_{A} is local-group-determined, so its positive image lies in **LG** by Theorem B.4.

(iii) for A. Let $\hat{k}=\max\{k,\ell,1\}$, $q\ge 2$ an even multiple of the exponent of the group of g', $u=\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{abc})^q\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$ and $v=\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{bac})^q\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$. Both are long for $s_{k,\ell}$ with prefix $\mathtt{a}^k$ and suffix $\mathtt{a}^\ell$, and $g'(u)=g'(\mathtt{a})^{2\hat{k}}=g'(v)$; so $t(u)=t(v)$. But $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(u)=q$ is even and $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(v)=1$ (only at $\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}\mathtt{b}$). With $z=\$\mathtt{1234}$, Lemma 6.6 applies. A typing with positive image in $\mathbf{LI}\vee\mathbf{Grp}$ satisfies the hypothesis by Lemma 4.12.

(iii) for B. Let $\hat{k}\ge\max\{k,\ell,1\}$ be even, $u=\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{ab})^3\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$ and $v=\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{ab})^2\mathtt{ba}\,\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$. They have the same prefix $\mathtt{a}^k$, suffix $\mathtt{a}^\ell$ and Parikh vector, so $t(u)=t(v)$ for abelian g'. Since $\alpha^2=\beta^2=1$, $\alpha\beta$ has order 3 and $\beta\alpha=(\alpha\beta)^{-1}$, we get $g_{\mathrm{B}}(u)=(\alpha\beta)^3=1$ and $g_{\mathrm{B}}(v)=(\alpha\beta)^2(\alpha\beta)^{-1}=\alpha\beta\neq 1$. With $z=\$\mathtt{1234}$, Lemma 6.6 applies. For $\mathbf{LI}\vee\mathbf{Ab}$, the proof of Lemma 4.12 with an abelian group factor gives an abelian g'.

Consequences. If $s_{\mathrm{A}}(\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}}^+)$ were in $\mathbf{LI}\vee\mathbf{Grp}$, (iii) with $t=s_{\mathrm{A}}$ would contradict (ii). The window, window–group and window–abelian theorems and Corollary 4.13 assume a typing of the excluded kind. □

Remark 6.9 (Scope of the separations). These propositions separate *typing classes*; they do not show that local-group or nonabelian shortening is needed for short data for L_{A} or L_{B}. Indeed, refining s_{A} by the syntactic morphism of Q_{A} gives a typing s' with $L_{\mathrm{A}}=\widehat{s'}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}')\cap\varphi_\times^{-1}(0)$, so Theorem 5.4 gives polynomial data for $\mathcal{B}^{\le 2}_{f,s'}$ (similarly for L_{B}); this concerns the refined operator, not $\mathcal{B}^{\le 2}_{f,s_{\mathrm{A}}}$. The separation also happens at arity one (Lemma 6.6), so these examples isolate the expressiveness of the typing, not its interaction with interleaved components (Example A.6).

6.3 An Intrinsically Rank-Two Boundary-Typed Target

Let $\Sigma_{\mathrm{intr}}:=\{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b},\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r},\mathtt{p},\mathtt{q},\mathtt{c},\mathtt{d},\#,\$,\mathtt{u},\mathtt{v},\mathtt{w}\}$, $P_{\mathrm{intr}}:=\{\mathtt{lpc},\mathtt{lpd},\mathtt{lqc},\mathtt{rpc},\mathtt{rpd}\}$,

$$\mathrm{MIX}_2^+:=\{x\in\{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b}\}^+:|x|_{\mathtt{a}}=|x|_{\mathtt{b}}\},\quad T_3^+:=\{\mathtt{u}^n\mathtt{v}^n\mathtt{w}^n:n\ge 1\},\quad L_{\mathrm{intr}}:=P_{\mathrm{intr}}\,\#\,\mathrm{MIX}_2^+\,\$\,T_3^+.$$

The factor MIX_2^+ forces rule rank two, T_3^+ forces fan-out two, and the wrapper P_{intr} separates the target from $\mathsf{YSub}(f)$.

Lemma 6.10 (Rank-one MCFLs are finite-index EDT0L)**.** *Every language in* $\mathsf{MCFL}(f',1)$ *has an EDT0L system of index at most* f'*.*

Proof. Let H be reduced, of fan-out $\le f'$ and rank ≤ 1. Use a symbol $[B,j]$ for each nonterminal B and component j, axiom $[S,1]$, and for each rule $A\to\rho(B)$ (or $A\to\rho$) a table mapping $[A,j]$ to the jth component of ρ with ξ_1^k replaced by $[B,k]$, and fixing every other symbol. Since each rule has at most one child and is linear, every reachable sentential form contains symbols of a single nonterminal, each at most once, so at most f' nonterminal occurrences. Table sequences that produce terminal words correspond to derivations of H (components of the child not used by a deleting rule are completed by any derivation, as H is reduced), with the same terminal word. □

Theorem 6.11 (A non-context-free intrinsic-rank-two typed witness)**.** $L_{\mathrm{intr}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(2,2) \setminus \mathrm{CFL}$*, and* $L_{\mathrm{intr}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{1,1}} \setminus \mathsf{YSub}(f)$ *for every* $f \geq 2$*, but* $L_{\mathrm{intr}} \notin \mathsf{MCFL}(f',1)$ *for every finite* f'*. Thus its minimum fan-out is two and its minimum rule rank over all finite-fan-out presentations is two: Theorem 4.9 applies to it, while Theorem 5.1 does not at any finite fan-out.*

Proof. Grammar. The fan-out-one rules $B \to \mathtt{a}B\mathtt{b}B \mid \mathtt{b}B\mathtt{a}B \mid \mathtt{a}B\mathtt{b} \mid \mathtt{ab}B \mid \mathtt{ab} \mid \mathtt{b}B\mathtt{a} \mid \mathtt{ba}B \mid \mathtt{ba}$ give $L_B = \mathrm{MIX}_2^+$: every word they generate is balanced, and conversely a balanced word decomposes at the first return of $|\cdot|_{\mathtt{a}} - |\cdot|_{\mathtt{b}}$ to zero as $\mathtt{a}y\mathtt{b}z$ or $\mathtt{b}y\mathtt{a}z$ with y, z balanced and possibly empty. With $A \to (\mathtt{u},\mathtt{w}) \mid (\mathtt{u}\xi^1_1\mathtt{v}, \mathtt{w}\xi^2_1)(A)$ we get $L_A = \{(\mathtt{u}^n\mathtt{v}^{n-1}, \mathtt{w}^n)\}$, and the rules $S \to (\alpha\#\xi^1_1\$\xi^1_2\mathtt{v}\xi^2_2)(B,A)$, $\alpha \in P_{\mathrm{intr}}$, generate L_{intr}. The grammar is reduced and good (the components of A are separated by $\mathtt{v}$), of fan-out and rank two.

Not context-free. Intersecting with $\mathtt{lpc}\#\mathtt{ab}\$\mathtt{u}^+\mathtt{v}^+\mathtt{w}^+$ and erasing the prefix gives T_3^+.

Typed membership. $L_{\mathrm{intr}} = Q_{\mathrm{intr}} \cap \Phi^{-1}(0)$, where $Q_{\mathrm{intr}} := P_{\mathrm{intr}}\#\{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b}\}^+\$\,\mathtt{u}^+\mathtt{v}^+\mathtt{w}^+$ is strictly 2-local, with pairs $\vdash \mathtt{l}$, $\vdash \mathtt{r}$, $\mathtt{lp}, \mathtt{lq}, \mathtt{rp}, \mathtt{pc}, \mathtt{pd}, \mathtt{qc}, \mathtt{c}\#, \mathtt{d}\#$, $\#x$, xy, $x\$$ ($x, y \in \{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b}\}$), $\$\mathtt{u}, \mathtt{uu}, \mathtt{uv}, \mathtt{vv}, \mathtt{vw}, \mathtt{ww}, \mathtt{w} \dashv$ (the first six letter pairs admit exactly the words of P_{intr}), and $\Phi : \Sigma^*_{\mathrm{intr}} \to \mathbb{Z}^3$ maps $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{u}, \mathtt{v}, \mathtt{w}$ to $(1,0,0), (-1,0,0), (0,1,0), (0,-1,1), (0,0,-1)$ and other letters to 0. Lemma 6.2 and Proposition 2.9 give $L_{\mathrm{intr}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{1,1}}$ for $f \geq 2$.

Outside $\mathsf{YSub}(f)$*.* For $x = \mathtt{p}$, $y = \mathtt{q}$, $E = \mathtt{l}\Box_1\mathtt{c}\#\mathtt{ab}\$\mathtt{uvw}$, $F = \mathtt{r}\Box_1\mathtt{d}\#\mathtt{ab}\$\mathtt{uvw}$: $E[x], E[y], F[x] \in L_{\mathrm{intr}}$ but $F[y] \notin L_{\mathrm{intr}}$; the boundary typing separates x and y.

Rank one is impossible. $\mathsf{MCFL}(f',1)$ is closed under letter-to-word homomorphisms (apply them to the templates). If $L_{\mathrm{intr}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(f',1)$, erasing all letters except $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}$ would put MIX_2^+ in $\mathsf{MCFL}(f',1)$, hence make it EDT0L by Lemma 6.10, and then also $\mathrm{MIX}_2 = \mathrm{MIX}_2^+ \cup \{\varepsilon\}$ (EDT0L is closed under union). But MIX_2 is the word problem of $\mathbb{Z}$, which is not EDT0L [22]; Lemma 6.10 agrees with Gallot's characterization of non-branching MCFGs [21, Definition 38 and Theorems 28–29]. □

The two lower bounds come from separate factors, and the non-branching lower bound is prior work. What is specific here is that a strictly local wrapper and the $(1,1)$ boundary typing place the target inside the typed class while the substitution implication keeps it outside Yoshinaka's baseline.

7 Conclusion

This paper converts the qualitative positive-data learning principle for typed MCFGs into presentation-sensitive upper bounds on the *total encoded length* of characteristic samples. For reduced good grammars, window and window–finite-group typings yield $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$, including noncommutative groups and interleaved tuple components. Positive-image local-group typings yield $O(\|G\|^3\bar{\theta}_G)$ by coupling classical sliding-factor coordinates with the MCFG ordered-block decomposition and shortening. For arbitrary standard input grammars, component-pattern thickness controls the transfer of these bounds through normalization. Rank-one presentations admit a polynomial bound for every fixed typing. The refinement-thickness dichotomy (Corollary 4.16) places the exact boundary for polynomial full yield-type refinement thickness at **LG** at every fan-out; it does not establish necessity for characteristic-data length. The internal feature-licensing example in Proposition 6.3 is a non-context-free window–group typed target for which the untyped distributional substitution rule is unsound even with the boundary-window condition alone. No lower-bound theorem or separating family from the related CFG manuscript is required for these results.

Open Problem 7.1 (Characteristic-data length at higher fan-out). Fix $f \geq 2$. Is there a fixed finite-semigroup typing whose positive image lies outside **LG**, for which every target in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ with a

reduced good rank-bounded presentation still admits characteristic data polynomial in the original grammar size and rule thickness? Conversely, can the two-element semilattice U_1 already force a superpolynomial characteristic-data lower bound at higher fan-out? Corollary 4.16 answers the analogous *refinement-thickness* question, but it does not answer either question about characteristic data.

The key unresolved issue is whether higher-arity distributional constraints can be turned into short typed representatives for every fixed finite semigroup, or whether a fixed-typing counterexample exists.

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Data availability

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A Simultaneous Block Replacement in Finite Groups

Semigroup convention. The finite group A and the morphisms into it are auxiliary to the shortening proofs. The semantic typing is always the positive-image restriction of the window–group (or local-group) product, with the fresh identity used only to evaluate empty template factors; by Lemma E.1 this changes neither nonempty tuple comparisons nor the selected witnesses.

We now prove the purely group-theoretic statement used in Lemma 4.7 and Lemma B.6. The commutative case is a zero-sum argument; the general case needs an order-homogenization argument because, for $f \geq 2$, blocks of different indices can interleave differently on different lines. The proof has three logically separate parts: the classification of homogeneous point orders (Lemma A.4), the group-valued interval invariant (Lemma A.5), and the polynomial-size extraction of homogeneous indices (Lemma A.7). Neither the order classification nor the selection of a replacement interval assumes that the group is abelian.

Definition A.1 (Block-replacement family)**.** Let A be a finite group and $f \geq 1$. A *block-replacement family* of width f over A with index set $[m]$ consists of $d \leq f$ *lines*; on line c, a left-to-right sequence

of blocks $\beta_{c,1}, \dots, \beta_{c,q_c}$ and constants $a_{c,0}, \dots, a_{c,q_c} \in A$; for every block β an *owner* $o(\beta) \in [m]$ and two values $x_\beta, x'_\beta \in A$; every index owns at most f blocks. For $J \subseteq [m]$ put

$$\mathrm{val}_c(J) := a_{c,0}\, y_{c,1}\, a_{c,1} \cdots y_{c,q_c}\, a_{c,q_c}, \qquad y_{c,j} := \begin{cases} x'_{\beta_{c,j}}, & o(\beta_{c,j}) \in J, \\ x_{\beta_{c,j}}, & o(\beta_{c,j}) \notin J. \end{cases}$$

Lemma A.2 (Block replacement)**.** *In a block-replacement family of width f over A there is a nonempty $J \subseteq [m]$ with $\mathrm{val}_c(J) = \mathrm{val}_c(\emptyset)$ for every line c, provided that either* (a) *A is abelian and $m > \mathsf{d}(A^f)$, or* (b) *A is arbitrary and $m \geq M_{A,f}$, where d and $M_{A,f}$ are as in Section 4.3.*

Part (a) is proved below under commutativity, and part (b) under the arbitrary-group order homogenization argument.

Commutative groups: zero sums

Proof of Lemma A.2(a). Write A additively. By commutativity $\mathrm{val}_c(J) - \mathrm{val}_c(\emptyset) = \sum_{i \in J} \delta_{i,c}$, where $\delta_{i,c}$ is the sum of $x'_\beta - x_\beta$ over the blocks β of line c owned by i. Put $\delta_i = (\delta_{i,c})_c \in A^d$. A sequence over A^d of length $m > \mathsf{d}(A^f) \geq \mathsf{d}(A^d)$ has a nonempty zero-sum subsequence $(\delta_i)_{i \in J}$; the inequality holds because A^d embeds in A^f and a zero-sum-free sequence in a subgroup is zero-sum free in the group. □

Remark A.3 (Size of the zero-sum constant). The prefix-sum pigeonhole argument gives $\mathsf{d}(A^f) \leq |A|^f - 1$; the zero-sum bound is usually much stronger. Write $A \cong C_{n_1} \oplus \cdots \oplus C_{n_s}$ and $n = \exp(A) \geq 2$. Then

$$f \sum_{i=1}^{s} (n_i - 1) \;\leq\; \mathsf{d}(A^f) \;\leq\; (n-1) + n \log \frac{|A|^f}{n},$$

where the lower bound is attained by a basis sequence and the upper bound is due to van Emde Boas and Kruyswijk [33, Proposition 5.1.8 and Theorem 5.5.5]; for a p-group the lower bound is an equality [33, Theorem 5.5.9] (Olson). Hence $\mathsf{d}(A^f) = O(\exp(A)\, f \log |A|)$ is linear in f, whereas $|A|^f - 1$ is exponential; for $A = C_2$ the antichain bound drops from $2^f - 1$ to f. The value $\mathsf{d}(A^d)$ is also the limit of the argument as stated, since a zero-sum-free sequence of that length exists; we do not claim that a grammar realizes such a configuration.

A.1 Arbitrary Finite Groups: Order Homogenization

Lemma A.4 (A homogeneous block-order lemma)**.** *Fix positive integers e, n with $n \geq 3$. For each $t \in [e]$ and $i \in [n]$, let (t, i) be a distinct point on a line, with a total left-to-right order. Suppose that (i) the order of (t, i) and (u, i) is independent of i; and (ii) for each ordered pair (t, u), including $t = u$, the order of (t, i) and (u, j) for $i < j$ is independent of the choice of $i < j$. Then the types at the points have a partition into classes, each occupying a consecutive region of the line. Every class has one direction (increasing or decreasing in i); inside its region the points occur in n successive* chunks*, one per rank in that direction. Each chunk consists of exactly one point of each type in the class (in a fixed within-chunk order).*

Proof. By (ii) with $t = u$, each type's points are monotone. For distinct types t, u write X for $(t, i) < (u, j)$ and Y for $(u, i) < (t, j)$, $i < j$; both are uniform by (ii). Suppose first that both types increase. $X \wedge Y$ puts all points of rank i before all points of rank $j > i$. Under $X \wedge \neg Y$ all off-diagonal comparisons put t left of u, and so do equal ranks: $(u, i) < (t, i)$ would give $(t, 1) < (t, 2) < (u, 1) < (t, 1)$; thus the types are separated. The case $\neg X \wedge Y$ is symmetric, and

$\neg X \wedge \neg Y$ gives $(t,1) < (t,2) < (u,1) < (u,2) < (t,1)$, a contradiction. If t increases and u decreases, $X \wedge Y$ gives $(t,2) < (u,3) < (u,1) < (t,2)$ and $\neg X \wedge \neg Y$ gives $(t,3) < (u,2) < (t,1) < (t,3)$; under $X \wedge \neg Y$ all off-diagonal comparisons put t left of u, and a contrary equal-rank comparison would give $(t,1) < (u,2) < (u,1) < (t,1)$, contrary to (i), so the types are separated; $\neg X \wedge Y$ is symmetric. Reversing indices covers two decreasing types. Thus any two types are either *separated*, or have the same direction and are *interleaved by rank*.

Interleaving is transitive: if t interleaves with u and u with v, all three have one direction, say increasing; if t, v were separated with t to the left we would have $(v,1) < (u,2) < (t,3) < (v,1)$, and with v to the left $(t,1) < (u,2) < (v,3) < (t,1)$. Hence interleaving, with equality, partitions the types into classes. A type outside a class is separated from each type inside it and lies on the same side of all of them, since otherwise two interleaved types would be separated. So class regions are consecutive, the rank comparisons give successive chunks, and the within-chunk order is independent of rank by (i). □

Lemma A.5 (Simultaneous finite-group interval shortening)**.** *Let A be any finite group, and consider a block-replacement family of width f over A with $n \geq \max\{3, |A|^f\}$ indices in which all indices have the same number of blocks, the same lines for them and the same within-index order, and in which every cross-index comparison between the t-th block of index i and the u-th block of index j on a common line has the same truth value for all $i < j$. Then a nonempty interval J of indices satisfies* $\mathrm{val}_c(J) = \mathrm{val}_c(\emptyset)$ *for every line c.*

Proof. Apply Lemma A.4 on each line to the block types going to that line. Across all lines there are $q \leq f$ class regions. For such a region $\mathcal{Q}$, enumerate its chunks $1, \ldots, n$ from left to right. Assign any constant between two successive chunks to the chunk on its left; keep the initial and terminal constants outside the chunks. Since those two outer constants never change, equality of the ordered product between them is sufficient. In the following, P_p and Q_p refer to this interior product (so both begin at 1_A). Let P_p be the original value of its prefix ending after chunk p and Q_p the value of that prefix when chunks $1, \ldots, p$ are replaced; set $P_0 = Q_0 = 1_A$ and $\kappa_p^{\mathcal{Q}} = P_p Q_p^{-1}$. For $0 \leq p < p' \leq n$, the *ordered* value after replacing exactly chunks $p+1, \ldots, p'$ is

$$\underbrace{P_p}_{\text{old prefix}} \underbrace{(Q_p^{-1} Q_{p'})}_{\text{new middle}} \underbrace{(P_{p'}^{-1} P_n)}_{\text{old suffix}}.$$

The middle expression is correct even with constants between chunks: $Q_{p'} = Q_p$ (new middle) by the definition of prefix products. Therefore the displayed product equals P_n exactly when

$$P_p Q_p^{-1} Q_{p'} P_{p'}^{-1} = 1_A, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad \kappa_p^{\mathcal{Q}} = P_p Q_p^{-1} = P_{p'} Q_{p'}^{-1} = \kappa_{p'}^{\mathcal{Q}}.$$

No factors have been commuted. Note that this requires equality of *two boundary states*; it does not require an individual block's original and replacement values to agree.

If $\mathcal{Q}$ increases with the index order, replacing owners $(a, b]$ replaces chunks $(a, b]$ in the region. If the order decreases, the same owners occupy chunks $(n-b, n-a]$ (counted from the left). This reversal is why the two orientations must use distinct state indices. For $j = 0, \ldots, n$ define a state in A^q by taking $\kappa_j^{\mathcal{Q}}$ from each increasing and $\kappa_{n-j}^{\mathcal{Q}}$ from each decreasing class. There are $n+1 > |A|^q$ states, so two coincide, at $a < b$. Replacing the indices $a+1, \ldots, b$ then preserves every region value; everything else on every line is unchanged. □

Example A.6 (Two rows, three owners, reversed order, and noncommuting values). This finite example illustrates the *boundary-state identity*, not an invocation of the numerical pigeonhole threshold (which can be much larger than three). Work in the nonabelian group $A = S_3$ and put

$\alpha = (12)$, $\beta = (23)$, so that $\alpha^2 = \beta^2 = 1$ but $\alpha\beta \neq \beta\alpha$. There are three owners $i = 1, 2, 3$ with three blocks each: two blocks U_i, V_i on row 1, and one block W_i on row 2. Reading left to right, with the fixed group-valued material *shown explicitly*, the rows are

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{row 1:} \quad (U_1\,\beta\,V_1)\,\alpha\,(U_2\,\beta\,V_2)\,\alpha\,(U_3\,\beta\,V_3),\\ &\text{row 2:} \quad W_3\,\beta\,W_2\,\beta\,W_1. \end{aligned}$$

Thus row 1 has two owner types occurring in increasing rank chunks, while row 2 has one type in *decreasing* rank chunks. Originally take $U_i = \beta$, $V_i = 1$, $W_i = 1$ for all i; both complete rows have value 1. Now replace *exactly* owners $J = \{2, 3\}$ using the table

owner	U_i'	V_i'	W_i'	replaced?
1	β	1	1	no
2	1	1	$\beta\alpha\beta$	yes
3	$\alpha\beta\alpha\beta$	1	α	yes

(the unchanged entries in row 1 for owner 1 are listed for comparison). The row 1 chunk values were $(1, 1, 1)$ and become $(1, \beta, \alpha\beta\alpha)$; its complete new value is

$$1 \cdot \alpha \cdot \beta \cdot \alpha \cdot (\alpha\beta\alpha) = 1.$$

In the reverse-order row 2 the new value is

$$\alpha \cdot \beta \cdot (\beta\alpha\beta) \cdot \beta \cdot 1 = 1.$$

These are *ordered* calculations in S_3; neither replaces $\alpha\beta$ by $\beta\alpha$. More precisely, for the interval of owner indices $(a, b] = (1, 3]$, the increasing region of row 1 has $\kappa_1 = \kappa_3 = 1$, whereas the decreasing region of row 2 has $\kappa_{3-b} = \kappa_0 = \kappa_2 = \kappa_{3-a} = 1$. The same owner interval therefore matches the two *different* boundary-index orientations. Note that no individual replacement owner need preserve its original row contribution; only both *full row products* are fixed. In the general proof there can be up to f such regions on multiple rows, and their states are compared simultaneously.

Lemma A.7 (Polynomial order homogenization)**.** *Let $N \geq 3$, and define $m_0 = N$ and $m_{s+1} = (m_s - 1)^2 + 1$, so that $m_k \leq N^{2^k}$. Let T be a finite set of point types, each assigned to one of several lines. For every index $i \in [n]$ and $t \in T$ let $p_t(i)$ be a point on the line of t, the points on each line being distinct. Let Π be the set of ordered pairs (t, u), including $t = u$, of types on a common line, and put $k = |\Pi|$. If $n \geq m_k$, there is a set $I \subseteq [n]$ of N indices such that, for every $(t, u) \in \Pi$, the truth value of $p_t(i) < p_u(j)$ is the same for all $i < j$ in I.*

Proof. Treat the pairs one at a time, the pairs (t, t) first. Each step passes from a current index set of size at least $(m-1)^2 + 1$ to a subset of size at least m; homogeneity already obtained, and monotonicity of each type, persist in subsets. For (t, t), homogeneity means that p_t is monotone, and the Erdős–Szekeres theorem gives a monotone subsequence of length m.

For $t \neq u$, both p_t and p_u are already monotone. Relabel the current indices $1, \ldots, m'$ in order, with $m' \geq (m-1)^2 + 1$, and put $X(i, j) = [p_t(i) < p_u(j)]$ for $i < j$. Because $p_u(j)$ is monotone in j, every row $X(i, \cdot)$ is monotone; because $p_t(i)$ is monotone in i, every column $X(\cdot, j)$ is monotone. The respective directions are fixed over all rows and columns by the directions of the two point types. Replacing X by $1 - X$ if necessary, assume each row goes from 0 to 1.

If the columns go from 1 to 0, put $J(i) = \min\{j > i : X(i, j) = 1\}$ (or ∞); J is nondecreasing. Set $i_1 = 1$ and $i_{s+1} = J(i_s)$ while this is at most m'. For $a < b$, $i_b \geq J(i_a)$ and so $X(i_a, i_b) = 1$; if

the chain has m terms we are done. Otherwise its at most $m-1$ terms cut $[m']$ into at most $m-1$ intervals $[i_s, i_{s+1})$ and $[i_L, m']$, one of which has more than $m'/(m-1) > m-1$ indices; inside it every $i<j$ satisfies $j < J(i_s) \le J(i)$, so $X(i,j)=0$ (and $J \equiv \infty$ in the last interval).

If the columns go from 0 to 1, the set $\{X=1\}$ is closed upward in both coordinates. Let κ be the least index with $X(\kappa,\kappa+1)=1$, or $\kappa=m'$. For $\kappa \le i<j$, $X(i,j) \ge X(\kappa,\kappa+1)=1$; for $i<j\le\kappa$, $X(i,j)\le X(j-1,j)=0$. One of $[1,\kappa]$ and $[\kappa,m']$ has at least $(m'+1)/2 \ge m$ indices, because $(m-1)^2+1 \ge 2m-1$.

After all k pairs at least $m_0 = N$ indices remain, and $m_{s+1} \le m_s^2$ gives $m_k \le N^{2^k}$. □

Proof of Lemma A.2(b). If an index owns no blocks, choosing that index alone preserves every line, so assume each index owns at least one block. The *unary pattern* of an index records the number of its blocks, the line of each, and their order within any shared line; there are at most $f \cdot f^f \cdot f! = U_f$ patterns. Hence at least $N_{A,f}^{2^{f^2}}$ indices share one pattern; the blocks of all other indices are never replaced and are absorbed into the constants. Number the blocks of the common pattern as types $1,\dots,f'$ ($f' \le f$) and use their positions as points on their lines. There are at most f^2 ordered pairs of types on a common line, including $t=u$, and $m_k \le N^{2^k} \le N^{2^{f^2}}$ for $k \le f^2$, so Lemma A.7 with $N = N_{A,f}$ yields $N_{A,f}$ indices with constant cross-index comparisons for all $i<j$. These satisfy the hypotheses of Lemma A.5, which supplies the required nonempty interval. □

For fixed f, the constant $M_{A,f} = U_f \max\{3,|A|^f\}^{2^{f^2}}$ is polynomial in $|A|$; its exponent depends doubly exponentially on f.

B Local-Group Coordinates and MCFG Block Shortening

Semigroup convention. Throughout this subsection **LG** is tested on the *positive image* $S = \widehat{s}(\Sigma^+)$ of the typing, not on the canonical completion $S^\sharp$. Auxiliary group-valued maps and the displayed monoid morphisms are implementations whose restrictions to nonempty words define the semantic bias (Lemma E.1).

LG is the pseudovariety of finite semigroups S in which every local monoid eSe, with e idempotent, is a group; the classical relation $\mathbf{LG} = \mathbf{Grp} * \mathbf{D}$ places it within the sliding-window and delay-theorem theory [37, 38]. The equivalent exclusion of the two-element semilattice $U_1 = \{1,\zeta\}$ ($\zeta^2=\zeta$) is given by [36, Proposition 2.3]. The sliding-factor coordinates below are a self-contained implementation of this established algebra, tailored to the precise boundary and group values used here; they are not claimed as a new algebraic characterization. The contribution to MCFG learning is the factorization of group values into fixed separators and variable blocks in Lemma B.2, followed by simultaneous replacement of those blocks.

Throughout, Σ is nonempty, $k \ge 1$, and A is a finite group. For a word w with $|w| \ge k+1$ let $\sigma_k(w)$ be the sequence of its factors of length $k+1$, ordered by their starting positions.

Recall the local-group typing of Definition 4.14.

For $\ell = k$, words of length $< 2k$ are *short* and recorded exactly, while a *long* w is recorded by $\langle \mathrm{pref}_k(w), \mathrm{suf}_k(w)\rangle$ (Definition 2.4). For $s,p \in \Sigma^k$ write $J_\nu(s,p) := \prod_{i=1}^{k} \nu((sp)[i..i+k])$, the ordered product over the k factors of length $k+1$ of sp that start in s.

Lemma B.1 (Local-group typings are morphisms)**.** *The kernel of $\lambda_{k,\nu}$ is a congruence of finite index on Σ^*. Hence $\lambda_{k,\nu}$ is a homomorphism onto a finite monoid $M_{k,\nu}$. For long u,v,*

$$\lambda_{k,\nu}(uv) = \big(\langle \mathrm{pref}_k\, u, \mathrm{suf}_k\, v\rangle,\ \gamma_{k,\nu}(u)\, J_\nu(\mathrm{suf}_k\, u, \mathrm{pref}_k\, v)\, \gamma_{k,\nu}(v)\big).$$

Proof. The window component is a morphism by Definition 2.4. For long u, v, the factors of length $k+1$ of uv are, in order, those of u, the k factors starting in the last k positions of u (inside $\mathrm{suf}_k(u)\,\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$), and those of v. If u is short and v long, the factors starting in u lie inside $u\,\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$ and the rest are those of v, so $\gamma_{k,\nu}(uv)$ is determined by u, $\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$ and $\gamma_{k,\nu}(v)$; the case of long u and short v is symmetric, and if both are short uv is determined exactly. Thus $\lambda_{k,\nu}(uv)$ is a function of $\lambda_{k,\nu}(u)$ and $\lambda_{k,\nu}(v)$, and the image has at most $|\Sigma|^{<2k} + |\Sigma|^{2k}|A|$ elements. □

Lemma B.2 (Block decomposition)**.** *Let $w = x_0\beta_1 x_1 \cdots \beta_q x_q$ be a factorization of a word into designated blocks β_j and fixed words x_j. Let $w' = x_0\beta'_1 x_1 \cdots \beta'_q x_q$, where $\widehat{s}_{k,k}(\beta'_j) = \widehat{s}_{k,k}(\beta_j)$ for every j. Then $\widehat{s}_{k,k}(w') = \widehat{s}_{k,k}(w)$. If w is long, there are $c_0, \ldots, c_q \in A$, depending only on the x_j and the window types of the β_j, such that*

$$\gamma_{k,\nu}(w) = c_0\,\gamma_{k,\nu}(\beta_1)\,c_1 \cdots \gamma_{k,\nu}(\beta_q)\,c_q, \qquad \gamma_{k,\nu}(w') = c_0\,\gamma_{k,\nu}(\beta'_1)\,c_1 \cdots \gamma_{k,\nu}(\beta'_q)\,c_q.$$

Proof. A short block is recorded exactly, so $\beta'_j = \beta_j$, and we absorb it into the fixed words. Every remaining block is long and its replacement is long with the same first and last k letters; hence w' is long exactly when w is, with the same first and last k letters, which gives the window claim. A factor F of length $k+1$ of w either lies inside a long block β_j or meets each long block it touches only in a prefix or a suffix of length at most k (meeting both ends would force $|\beta_j| \le k$). Factors of the second kind are spelled by the fixed words and the windows of the blocks, and occur in the same order in w'. Ordering all factors by starting position, those inside β_j form one consecutive run contributing $\gamma_{k,\nu}(\beta_j)$; let c_j be the ordered product of the remaining factors between consecutive runs. □

Lemma B.3 (Explicit sliding-factor coordinates for block shortening)**.** *Let S be a finite semigroup with minimal ideal K and suppose every idempotent of S lies in K. Put $n = |S|$ and fix any morphism $h : \Sigma^+ \to S$. In a Rees representation $\mathsf{K} = \mathcal{M}(H; I, \Lambda; P)$ there is a map $\nu : \Sigma^{n+1} \to H$ such that, for every word w with $|w| \ge 2n$,*

$$h(w) = \big(\mathrm{row}(h(\mathrm{pref}_n\, w)),\ \mathrm{grp}(h(\mathrm{pref}_n\, w))\,\gamma_{n,\nu}(w),\ \mathrm{col}(h(\mathrm{suf}_n\, w))\big). \tag{$\star$}$$

Here row*,* grp *and* col *send $(i, a, \lambda) \in \mathsf{K}$ to $i \in I$, $a \in H$ and $\lambda \in \Lambda$, and $\gamma_{n,\nu}(w)$ is the* ordered *product of the $|w| - n$ sliding-factor labels from Definition 4.14. Consequently $h(w)$ is determined by the first and last n letters and this ordered product, with no commutativity hypothesis on H.*

Proof. (1) Uniform entry into K*.* The Rees quotient S/K has no idempotent except zero. Every element therefore has a power equal to zero. If a product of $m = |S/\mathsf{K}|$ factors were nonzero, its m nonempty prefix products would all be nonzero, so two, say $p_i = p_j$ with $i < j$, would coincide. With $x = s_{i+1} \cdots s_j$ we would have $p_i = p_i x^q$ for every q; taking q with $x^q = 0$ is a contradiction. Thus every product of $n \ge |S/\mathsf{K}|$ letters belongs to K.

(2) Outer coordinates and the right action. Write $(i, a, \lambda)(j, b, \mu) = (i, a p_{\lambda j} b, \mu)$. Fix $i_0 \in I$ and set $e_\lambda = (i_0, p^{-1}_{\lambda i_0}, \lambda) \in \mathsf{K}$. For all $(i, a, \lambda) \in \mathsf{K}$, multiplication on the right by e_λ is the identity. For $s \in S$ write $e_\lambda s = (j, c, \mu) \in \mathsf{K}$ and put $\rho(\lambda, s) = p_{\lambda j} c$. Associativity then gives the exact identity

$$(i, a, \lambda)s = (i, a\rho(\lambda, s), \mu(\lambda, s)).$$

In particular the I-coordinate is unchanged by right multiplication, even if $s \notin \mathsf{K}$. Dually, left multiplication preserves the Λ-coordinate of a product already in K: choose an idempotent $f_i \in \mathsf{K}$ with $f_i(i, a, \lambda) = (i, a, \lambda)$; then $s(i, a, \lambda) = (sf_i)(i, a, \lambda)$, and the Rees rule forces the same Λ-coordinate. The I-coordinate of a long word is therefore fixed by its first n letters, and its Λ-coordinate by its last n letters.

(3) The sliding-factor group coordinate. Write $w = a_1 \cdots a_m$, $m \geq 2n$, and set $h(a_1 \cdots a_n) = (i, a, \lambda_n)$. For $j \geq n$ let λ_j denote the Λ-coordinate of $h(a_1 \cdots a_j)$. Since left multiplication preserves the Λ-coordinate on K, this equals the Λ-coordinate of $h(a_{j-n+1} \cdots a_j)$; both products have length at least n. Define for each $F \in \Sigma^{n+1}$

$$\nu(F) = \rho\big(\mathrm{col}(h(F[1..n])),\, h(F[n+1])\big).$$

Successive applications of the right-action identity, in their actual left-to-right order, yield

$$h(w) = \Big(i,\ a \prod_{j=n}^{m-1} \nu(a_{j-n+1} \cdots a_{j+1}),\ \lambda_m\Big).$$

The displayed product is precisely $\gamma_{n,\nu}(w)$, and $\lambda_m = \mathrm{col}(h(\mathrm{suf}_n\, w))$. This proves $(\star)$. The case $m = 2n$ is included: it has exactly n sliding factors and the same boundary-coordinate formula. □

Theorem B.4 (Classical local-group criteria in sliding-factor coordinates)**.** *For a finite typing $s : \Sigma^+ \to \mathsf{S}$ put $S := \widehat{s}(\Sigma^+)$. The following are equivalent.*

(i) *$S \in \mathbf{LG}$; that is, eSe is a group for every idempotent e of S.*

(ii) *S has no subsemigroup isomorphic to U_1.*

(iii) *Every idempotent of S lies in the minimal ideal of S.*

(iv) *$\widehat{s}$ is local-group-determined. One may take $k = |S|$.*

Proof. The equivalence of (i)–(iii) is classical. More precisely, [36, Proposition 2.3] proves that (i) and (ii) are equivalent to $S^m = \mathsf{K}$ for some m, where K is the minimal ideal. By [36, Lemma 2.2], for $n = |S|$ one has $S^n = SE(S)S$. Thus $S^m = \mathsf{K}$ for some m if and only if $E(S) \subseteq \mathsf{K}$: the forward implication uses $e = e^m$ for every idempotent e, while the converse follows from $S^n = SE(S)S \subseteq \mathsf{K}$ and the fact that S^n is a nonempty ideal containing K.

(iii)⇒(iv). Apply Lemma B.3 to $h = \widehat{s}|_{\Sigma^+}$ with $n = |S|$. Equation $(\star)$ gives the value of $\widehat{s}(w)$ for every $|w| \geq 2n$ from its n-letter prefix, n-letter suffix, and the ordered sliding-factor product $\gamma_{n,\nu}(w)$. The window congruence $\widehat{s}_{n,n}$ records all shorter words exactly and separates ε by the fresh identity. Hence $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda_{n,\nu}$.

(iv)⇒(i). Since **LG** is closed under homomorphic images, it suffices to show that the positive image $T := \lambda_{k,\nu}(\Sigma^+)$ belongs to **LG**. No short element is idempotent: squaring a short word increases its length, which the window component records exactly up to the long threshold. Let $e = (\langle p, s\rangle, \gamma_e)$ be idempotent. By Lemma B.1, $\gamma_e J_\nu(s,p) \gamma_e = \gamma_e$; moreover, every exe $(x \in T)$ has window $\langle p, s\rangle$. Thus eTe lies in the group $H_e := \{(\langle p, s\rangle, \alpha) : \alpha \in A\}$, whose multiplication is $\alpha * \beta = \alpha J_\nu(s,p) \beta$ and which is isomorphic to A via $\alpha \mapsto \alpha J_\nu(s,p)$. The finite subsemigroup eTe is therefore a group. □

Proposition B.5 (Window–group typings are local-group typings, strictly)**.** (i) *If $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g)$ for a homomorphism g into a finite group, then $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda_{\hat{k},\nu}$ with $\hat{k} = \max\{k, \ell, 1\}$ and $\nu(F) := g(\text{last letter of } F)$. Hence $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$.*

(ii) *Let $\Sigma = \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}$. Let $h_{\mathtt{ab}} := \lambda_{1,\nu}$ with $\nu(\mathtt{ab}) = 1 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$ and $\nu(F) = 0$ otherwise; it records the parity of the number of occurrences of $\mathtt{ab}$, together with the window. Then $h_{\mathtt{ab}}$ is not window–group-determined. Hence $h_{\mathtt{ab}}(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG} \setminus (\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp})$.*

Proof. (i) For $|w| \geq 2\hat{k}$, $g(w) = g(\mathrm{pref}_{\hat{k}}\, w)\, \gamma_{\hat{k},\nu}(w)$, and shorter words are recorded exactly. For the inclusion, let $S \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ and take $\Sigma = S$ with the evaluation typing $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow S$. Lemma 4.12 makes $\widehat{s}$ window–group determined, hence local-group-determined by the first part, so $S \in \mathbf{LG}$ by Theorem B.4.

(ii) Suppose $h_{\mathtt{ab}} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g')$ with $g' : \Sigma^* \to A'$. Let $\hat{k} = \max\{k, \ell, 1\}$ and let q be an even multiple of the exponent of A'. Put $u = \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{abc})^q \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$ and $v = \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{bac})^q \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$. Both are long, with prefix $\mathtt{a}^k$ and suffix $\mathtt{a}^\ell$, and $g'(u) = g'(\mathtt{a})^{2\hat{k}} = g'(v)$. But u contains q occurrences of $\mathtt{ab}$, while v contains exactly one, at $\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}\mathtt{b}$, so $h_{\mathtt{ab}}(u) \neq h_{\mathtt{ab}}(v)$. Membership in **LG** follows from Theorem B.4; if the positive image were in $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$, Lemma 4.12 would make $h_{\mathtt{ab}}$ window–group-determined. □

Lemma B.6 (Short tuples with prescribed local-group type)**.** *Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be a reduced good MCFG of fan-out at most f and rule rank at most $r_{\max} \geq 1$, and let $\lambda = \lambda_{k,\nu}$. Let $b_{\mathrm{w}} := b_{k,k} = (r_{\max}+1)\bar{\theta}_G\, f(2k+1)\, |V||M_{k,k}|^f$ be the window constant of Corollary 4.8. Put $n_\lambda := |V||M_{k,\nu}|^f$, and let $M_{A,f}$ be the constant of Section 4.3. For every $B \in V$ and every realizable $\mathbf{t} \in M_{k,\nu}^{\mathrm{fan}(B)}$ there is $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$ with $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$ and*

$$\|\vec{u}\|_1 \leq \beta_\lambda := (r_{\max}+1)\, b_{\mathrm{w}} \max\{1, (M_{A,f}-1)\, n_\lambda\}.$$

If A is abelian, $M_{A,f} - 1$ may be replaced by $\mathtt{d}(A^f)$.

Proof. Let T be minimal as in Lemma 4.5 with root λ-vector $\mathbf{t}$ and threshold $b = b_{\mathrm{w}} \geq \bar{\theta}_G$. For a heavy node v labelled C with yield $\vec{x}$, Corollary 4.8 gives a replacement tuple $\vec{x}' \in L_C(G)$ with the same $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$-vector and $\|\vec{x}'\|_1 \leq b_{\mathrm{w}}$. For pairwise incomparable heavy nodes $v_1, \ldots, v_m$ and $J \subseteq [m]$, let T_J replace the subtrees at v_i, $i \in J$. The components of the v_i are disjoint contiguous blocks of the root components. By Lemma B.2, every T_J has the root window vector of T; a short root component is unchanged, and on each long root component $\gamma_{k,\nu}$ is an ordered product $c_0 y_1 c_1 \cdots y_q c_q$ of block values between constants that do not depend on J. The long root components thus form a block-replacement family over A (Definition A.1). If $m \geq M_{A,f}$, or $m > \mathtt{d}(A^f)$ for abelian A, Lemma A.2 gives a nonempty J with the root λ-vector of T, while T_J is strictly shorter. This contradicts minimality, and Lemma 4.5 with $N = M_{k,\nu}$ gives the bound. □

By Proposition B.5(i), this theorem also applies to window and window–group typings, but its general cubic bound is weaker than the quadratic bounds proved for those subclasses in Theorems 4.9 and 4.10.

C Pattern-Thickness Transfer for General MCFG Presentations

Here are the support-fibre details behind Proposition 4.19. Write $F_{A,I} := \{\vec{u} \in L_A(H_{\mathrm{red}}) : \mathrm{supp}(\vec{u}) = I\}$. Every realized fibre has a shortest tuple, of length at most $t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$.

For clarity, the source-language invariant is preserved *through all four stages*: each intermediate decorated nonterminal is the image of a union of realizable original fibres $F_{A,I}$ under one composition of projection, permutation and consecutive-component merging; where an intermediate support is prescribed, retain only the original fibres whose image has that support. The map is length-nonincreasing, and every such fibre has an actual derivation in the trimmed input. The stagewise bookkeeping is:

Stage	Tuple-language operation	Support/length information
(a) Nondeletion	$\pi_J(L_A)$, union over source fibres	Omitted children have derivations; projection does not increase length
(b) Nonpermutation	$\sigma(\pi_J(L_A))$	Support is permuted; length is unchanged
(c) Empty-pattern removal	Restrict to a realized support I, then π_I	Select preimage source fibres with the required support; length does not increase
(d) Nonmerging	$\mu(\sigma\pi_J(L_A))$, with the support restriction inherited from (c)	Merged support is a function of previous support; length is unchanged

In this table, L_A refers to the original input nonterminal and the operations are understood as applying to the appropriate union of $F_{A,I}$, not to an unrestricted L_A after stage (c). The original rank and fan-out bounds survive because the four constructions introduce only finitely many component decorations per rule for fixed f, r.

At stage (a) of Lemma F.1, a new nonterminal has language $\pi_J(L_A(H_{\mathrm{red}}))$, a union of the images $\pi_J(F_{A,I})$. Stage (b) permutes components and thus permutes support patterns without changing total length. At stage (c), restricting to a realized output pattern selects the images of those original support fibres whose projected/permuted support is exactly that pattern. Because each such original fibre is nonempty, selecting its shortest tuple yields an output tuple of total length at most $t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$. Stage (d) merges consecutive components; concatenation cannot increase total length, and its output support is determined by the input support, so the same argument applies after merging. The stagewise equalities are equalities of tuple languages, not merely inclusions; hence each retained nonterminal has an actual bounded-length terminal derivation. Fresh nonterminal names are only the finite decorators of these source nonterminals. Final trimming removes symbols without changing the tuple languages of the surviving ones. This proves $t_G \le t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}})$.

The normal form has $\|G\| = O_{f,r}(\|H\|)$ by Proposition 3.12; consequently $\bar{\theta}_G \le 2\max\{1, \|G\|\}\max\{1, t_G\} = O_{f,r}(\|H\|\bar{t}_{\mathrm{pat}}(H_{\mathrm{red}}))$ by Lemma 4.1(iii). This argument does not assert polynomial control by the *ordinary* untyped rule thickness of H: Proposition F.3 shows why elimination of empty components can be expensive.

Example C.1 (An explicit four-stage fan-out-two transfer). Here is a finite example in which *deletion, permutation, an empty component, and a merge* all occur. It illustrates the exact source-fibre invariant used above, rather than replacing the proof of Lemma F.1. Let the terminal alphabet contain $a, b, c, d, z, \#$ and take fan-out-one start symbol S, fan-out-two symbols A, B, C, and the rank-≤ 2 grammar

$$\begin{aligned} B &\to (a,\varepsilon) \mid (a,b),\\ C &\to (c,d),\\ A &\to (\xi_1^2\xi_1^1, \xi_2^1)(B,C) \mid (\varepsilon, z),\\ S &\to (\xi_1^1 \# \xi_1^2)(A) \mid (\varepsilon). \end{aligned}$$

The first A-rule *deletes* C's second component d, uses B's components in *reverse* order, and puts the adjacent pieces B^2B^1 together. The terminal tuple (ε, z) realizes the support pattern $\{2\}$, whereas the other A-derivations realize $\{1,2\}$. Direct evaluation gives

X	realized tuple fibres (by support)	minimum lengths per fibre
B	$F_{B,\{1\}} = \{(a,\varepsilon)\}, \quad F_{B,\{1,2\}} = \{(a,b)\}$	$1, 2$
C	$F_{C,\{1,2\}} = \{(c,d)\}$	2
A	$F_{A,\{2\}} = \{(\varepsilon,z)\}, \quad F_{A,\{1,2\}} = \{(a,c),(ba,c)\}$	$1, 2$
S	$F_{S,\emptyset} = \{(\varepsilon)\}, \quad F_{S,\{1\}} = \{(\#z),(a\#c),(ba\#c)\}$	$0, 2$

The last column records the minimum length *within each realized support fibre*, rather than the lengths of all its tuples. For example, $\|(a,c)\|_1 = 2$ and $\|(ba,c)\|_1 = 3$, so the minimum for $F_{A,\{1,2\}}$ is 2. Thus $t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H) = 2$ for this H and $L(H) = \{\varepsilon, \#z, a\#c, ba\#c\}$.

Stage (a): projecting C to its used component gives $C^{\{1\}} \to (c)$ with language $\pi_{\{1\}}(L_C) = \{(c)\}$; the deleted d is restored by the omitted component in the original C-derivation. All derived A-tuples are unchanged.

Stage (b): the decorated reverse-order copy of B has language $\{(\varepsilon, a), (b, a)\}$. Reading this copy in its own component order makes the first A-rule nonpermuting. This is precisely a permutation image of L_B, and neither support nor length is silently changed (the support is permuted).

Stage (c): the two nonempty support fibres of this reordered B become $\{(a)\}$ from $\{2\}$ and $\{(b,a)\}$ from $\{1,2\}$. The A-copy of support $\{2\}$ generates (z), whereas the $\{1,2\}$-copy generates (a,c) and (ba,c). The positive start language is $\{\#z, a\#c, ba\#c\}$; its separate ε-rule is removed. In particular, the all-empty output is not accidentally reconstructed by a good-rule template.

Stage (d): the contiguous pair (b,a) in the reordered B-copy is merged to (ba); the singleton fibre remains (a). The corresponding A-copy still generates exactly (a,c) or (ba,c) and S retains exactly the three positive words. After collapsing duplicate names, one possible *final good grammar* for the nonempty core is the following fully explicit one:

$$
\begin{array}{rcl@{\qquad}rcl}
D_0 & \to & (a), & D_1 & \to & (ba), \\
C_0 & \to & (c), & A_2 & \to & (z), \\
A_{12} & \to & (\xi_1^1, \xi_2^1)(D_0, C_0) \mid (\xi_1^1, \xi_2^1)(D_1, C_0), & & & \\
S_+ & \to & (\#\,\xi_1^1)(A_2) \mid (\xi_1^1\,\#\,\xi_1^2)(A_{12}). & & &
\end{array}
$$

Here D_0 and D_1 are exactly the two transformed B fibres: $L_{D_0} = \{(a)\}$ and $L_{D_1} = \{(ba)\}$; the omitted d from C contributes no root output. Each displayed component is nonempty, no child component is deleted, permuted, or separately merged at a rule, and the fan-out and rank remain 2. For each output copy, a representative is the image of a tuple in one of the displayed *original* fibres under a composition $\mu\sigma\pi_J$, possibly after conditioning on a realized support pattern. Each map is length-nonincreasing, and the shortest chosen original-fibre representative has length at most two. Thus every surviving decorated nonterminal has a terminal yield of length at most $2 = t_{\mathrm{pat}}(H)$, as asserted by the general transfer. In this example the difference between preserving the *whole source language* and preserving a *support fibre* is visible at stage (c).

D Auxiliary Verification of Qualitative Reconstruction

D.1 Soundness

Proof of Lemma 3.2. Replace the children one at a time, keeping all other children fixed and nonempty. Given an accepting outer context E for the result of any intermediate replacement, Lemma 3.1 induces an admissible context E_j of the child being replaced. Since $\vec{u}_j \equiv_{L,s} \vec{x}_j$, membership in L is unchanged under that replacement, in either direction. The same argument applies at each step even if earlier children have already been replaced. Finally, the componentwise s-types of the output tuples agree because the template is fixed and $\widehat{s}$ is multiplicative on concatenation, including the fresh identity for empty terminal gaps. Therefore the output distributions coincide. □

Proof of Proposition 3.10. Proceed by induction on the height of a derivation rooted at $[\vec{x}]$. A Const rule derives exactly $\vec{x}$. For Link, $[\vec{x}] \to [\vec{y}]$ is witnessed by a common admissible context of same-type tuples in $K \subseteq L$, hence tuple substitutability gives $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{y}$; compose this equivalence with the inductive hypothesis for $[\vec{y}]$. For Comp, each child derivation produces a tuple equivalent

to its witnessed child, and Lemma 3.2 transfers those equivalences through the witnessed template. Its original output is exactly the observed parent $\vec{x}$, establishing the invariant. Every positive Start rule points to an observed sentence (w), whose derivational context is the identity; the invariant implies $w \in L$. The empty Start rule is included only for $\varepsilon \in K \subseteq L$. This argument holds at every finite rank cap; for nonempty K the uncapped construction has cap $\|K\|_+$, and the empty case is immediate. □

D.2 Effective Reconstruction and Conservative Learning

Proof of Theorem 3.14. Put $n_K = \max\{1, \|K\|_+\}$. An occurrence is a sample word with at most $2f$ cut positions, so there are $n_K^{O(f)}$ occurrences, typed by fixed-monoid products; grouping occurrences by context and type lists the Link rules. A composition witness of rank $r \le r_{\max}$ is determined by a parent occurrence and at most $2fr_{\max}$ further cut positions inside it, with a labelling whose number depends only on $f, r_{\max}$; goodness is checked directly. This gives $n_K^{O(fr_{\max})}$ candidate Comp rules; the remaining rules have rank at most one, and deduplication leaves an encoding of the same size. □

Proof of Corollary 3.16. For fixed rule rank, qualitative identification follows from the direct soundness and exact-reconstruction results (Proposition 3.10 and Theorem 3.13) with the conservative policy of [14, Algorithm 1]; the finite-signature antecedent is Yoshinaka [15, Theorem 1]. For unbounded rank, Theorem 3.13 provides a finite characteristic sample, while Proposition 3.10 gives soundness. Membership is decidable [29]. After a text has presented the characteristic sample, the next rebuild (if any) is correct and permanent; if no rebuild follows, sample consistency and conservativeness imply that the current hypothesis already generates every text word and hence L. For fixed rank, the per-datum bound follows from Theorem 3.14 and [14, Proposition 4]. □

Update complexity versus convergence stage. The polynomial-time guarantee of Theorem 3.14 and Corollary 3.16 concerns hypothesis reconstruction and membership testing at each finite stage, measured against the data seen so far. TxtEx convergence in Corollary 3.16 does not bound the first stage of stabilization or the number of mind changes polynomially: a text may postpone the first presentation of a particular positive example arbitrarily long. Short characteristic data by itself gives no presentation-independent convergence-stage bound.

Every CFG has a rank-two presentation, so $\mathcal{A}_{1,s}^{\le 2}$ covers $\mathcal{C}_{1,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$; this does not imply polynomial characteristic-data length at rank two (Section 4).

Proof of Proposition 3.11. This is the rule-witness argument of [15, Lemma 3], applied to the concrete Link/Const/Comp presentation. For each typed rule put $\vec{z} = \rho(\iota(Y_1), \dots, \iota(Y_q))$. The two witnesses supply Link $[\iota(X)] \to [\vec{z}]$, followed by Const if $q = 0$ or Comp of rank $q \le r_G$ otherwise. The latter also belongs to the uncapped grammar, since $q \le \|\vec{z}\|_1 \le \|K\|_+$. Induction on a source derivation thus simulates $X \Rightarrow_{\widetilde{G}_0}^{*} \vec{u}$ from $[\iota(X)]$; $\chi(X) = \square_1$ at a successful start link supplies Start. Apply Proposition 3.6(iii). □

Proof of Theorem 3.13. If $L \cap \Sigma^+ = \emptyset$ then $K = L \in \{\emptyset, \{\varepsilon\}\}$ and the claim is immediate from Definition 3.4. Otherwise $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq L$ is finite by the remark after Definition 3.9. Proposition 3.11 with $\iota = \omega$ (admissible by Proposition 3.6(i)) gives $L \cap \Sigma^+ \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}(K))$, and Proposition 3.10 gives $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) \subseteq L$, for both operators. The hypothesis contains ε iff $\varepsilon \in K$, iff $\varepsilon \in L$, because $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq K \subseteq L$. Rank-preserving normalization gives the last sentence. □

E Auxiliary Proofs for Typed Witness Construction

The statements used for quantitative witness bounds remain in Section 3.2; the routine verification details are recorded here.

Proof of Proposition 3.6. At every rule application, the monoid morphism property gives

$$\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\rho(\vec{u}_1,\dots,\vec{u}_r)) = \mathrm{out}_\rho(\widehat{s}^{(d_1)}(\vec{u}_1),\dots,\widehat{s}^{(d_r)}(\vec{u}_r)).$$

Induction on derivation height gives (i) and the unique lifting (ii). Erasing indices gives $L(G^{\widehat{s}}) \subseteq L(G)$, (ii) the converse, and trimming keeps every rule of every successful derivation. □

Definitions 2.8, 3.4 and 3.5 apply verbatim with any finite-monoid morphism $h : \Sigma^* \to N$ in place of $\widehat{s}$ (types of tuples being $h^{(d)}$); write $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$ for the resulting class. The class and the reconstruction operator use types of nonempty components only, hence depend only on $h|_{\Sigma^+}$.

Lemma E.1 (Monoid implementations)**.** *Let $h_0 : \Sigma^* \to M_0$ be a finite-monoid morphism, $S_0 := h_0(\Sigma^+)$ and $s_0 := h_0|_{\Sigma^+}$.*

(i) *For $1 \le d \le f$ and $\vec{x},\vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$, the equalities $h_0^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = h_0^{(d)}(\vec{y})$, $s_0^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s_0^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ and $\widehat{s_0}^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \widehat{s_0}^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ are equivalent. Hence $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h_0} = \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_0}$, and the reconstruction operators built with h_0 and with $\widehat{s_0}$ return the same grammar on every sample.*

(ii) *For every good MCFG G, the trimmed refinements of G under h_0 and under $\widehat{s_0}$ coincide (the untrimmed ones need not); hence the same canonical tuples, contexts and witness words may be chosen for both.*

Proof of Lemma E.1. (i) The three maps agree on Σ^+ as maps into S_0, and the class and the Link guard compare types of nonempty components only. (ii) S_0 is a subsemigroup of M_0 and of $S_0^\sharp$ with the same multiplication. By λ-freeness and Proposition 3.6(i), every typed nonterminal occurring in a successful derivation under either morphism is some $A_{\mathbf{t}}$ with $\mathbf{t} \in S_0^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$, and the start links used are $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(\eta)}$ with $\eta \in S_0$. For child indices in S_0, every component α_i of a good template is a nonempty word whose letters and variables are evaluated in S_0 identically under both morphisms, so both give the same out_ρ. Thus the two full refinements contain the same rules among S_0-indexed symbols, which carry all successful derivations. □

Proof of Lemma 3.7. Take a successful typed derivation containing X, and follow the path from the root to an occurrence of X, starting with $\Box_1$. At each rule on the path apply Lemma 3.1 with the (nonempty) yields of the sibling subderivations fixed; this gives $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_d$. The rules on the path depend only on the label X, so replacing the subtree of X by any X-derivation yields a successful derivation of $\chi(X)[\vec{u}]$. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is a rule, use the path of length zero. □

Proof of Lemma 3.8. For $\vec{u},\vec{v} \in L_X$, Proposition 3.6(i) gives equal types and $\chi(X)$ accepts both; substitutability gives $\mathcal{D}_L(\vec{u}) = \mathcal{D}_L(\vec{v})$. □

F Details of the Good Normalization

The normalization uses the four stagewise constructions in Lemma F.1; their semantic and size invariants are verified below.

We record the four conversions used in Proposition 3.12 once, together with the tuple-language identity that each satisfies. Both the fixed-parameter size bound of that proposition and the

thickness transfer of Proposition F.2 are read off from these identities. Semantic correctness of the nondeleting and nonmerging conversions is standard [14, 29, 31]; Kanazawa's existence statement [31, Section 2.1] does not by itself give the size or thickness bounds, which are therefore derived here. For $\vec{w} = (w_1, \ldots, w_d)$ and nonempty $I \subseteq [d]$, $\pi_I(\vec{w})$ retains the components indexed by I in increasing order, $\sigma\vec{w}$ permutes components, and $\mu(\vec{w})$ concatenates consecutive blocks of components; thus $\|\pi_I(\vec{w})\|_1 \le \|\vec{w}\|_1$ and $\|\sigma\vec{w}\|_1 = \|\mu(\vec{w})\|_1 = \|\vec{w}\|_1$.

Lemma F.1 (Stagewise tuple languages)**.** *Fix f and $r_{\max}$, and let G_0 be a reduced f-MCFG of rule rank at most $r_{\max}$. Each of the following conversions preserves linearity, does not increase fan-out or rule rank, and multiplies the number of nonterminal and rule copies by a factor depending only on f and $r_{\max}$, without enlarging any template.*

(a) Nondeletion *(the construction (f3) in the proof of [29, Lemma 2.2]). Introduce A^I for nonempty $I \subseteq [\mathrm{fan}(A)]$. For $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_q)$ let J_j be the set of components of B_j used by the I-indexed outputs of ρ; keep these outputs, rename their variables, use $B_j^{J_j}$ when $J_j \neq \emptyset$ and omit B_j otherwise. The resulting rules are nondeleting, and $L_{A^I} = \pi_I(L_A(G_0))$.*

(b) Nonpermutation. *Decorate a fan-out-d nonterminal by $\sigma \in \mathfrak{S}_d$; the order in which a permuted parent template uses a child's variables determines the child's permutation. The decorated nonterminal generates σL_A.*

(c) Empty components. *Let $\mathsf{Pat}(A)$ be the set of nonempty-component patterns of tuples in L_A, computed by finite saturation. For realizable child patterns, replace variables of absent components by ε, delete empty parent components and omit all-empty children; introduce A^I for each nonempty $I \in \mathsf{Pat}(A)$. Then L_{A^I} is the set of π_I-projections of the tuples of L_A with pattern I, the result is λ-free, and $S^{\{1\}}$ generates the nonempty part of the language. If every derived component is already nonempty, this stage is the identity.*

(d) Nonmerging *(the construction in the proof of [14, Section 2.3, Lemma 1]). Decorate a nonterminal by a composition μ of its fan-out; in a merged parent template, maximal adjacent runs of consecutive variables of a child determine that child's merge. The merge-decorated nonterminal generates the* image $L_{A^\mu} = \mu(L_A)$.

Stages (b)–(d) preserve the conditions established by earlier stages.

Proof. (a) For arbitrary child tuples, $\pi_I(\rho(\vec{v}_1, \ldots, \vec{v}_q)) = \rho^I\big((\pi_{J_j}\vec{v}_j)_{J_j \neq \emptyset}\big)$, so induction on derivations gives $\subseteq$. For $\supseteq$, lift every retained child tuple by the induction hypothesis and supply a terminal derivation of each omitted child; this uses that G_0 is reduced, hence every omitted child is productive. Without prior trimming only $\pi_I(L_A) \subseteq L_{A^I}$ would be automatic. There are at most 2^f copies of each nonterminal, and I determines the J_j, so at most 2^f copies of each rule; omitting children cannot increase rank.

(b) Linearity and nondeletion make the induced child permutations well defined; induction in both directions identifies the language with σL_A. There are at most $f!$ copies, no child is duplicated, and total length, λ-freeness, fan-out and rank are preserved.

(c) Retained variables still occur once and in order, so nondeletion, nonpermutation, fan-out and rank are preserved. Induction on derivations gives the projection identity; omitted all-empty children are restored by terminal derivations realizing their all-empty pattern. There are at most 2^f patterns per nonterminal and $2^{f r_{\max}}$ choices per rule, and projection only shortens templates.

(d) Nonpermutation makes the maximal runs compatible with each child's component order, and nondeletion makes them cover all its components. The merged template satisfies

$\rho^{\mu}(\mu_1(\vec{v}_1),\dots,\mu_q(\vec{v}_q)) = \mu(\rho(\vec{v}_1,\dots,\vec{v}_q))$, and induction gives the image equality. No inverse-image claim is made, because the merge map need not be injective. Concatenation preserves total length, λ-freeness, nonpermutation, fan-out and rank; for fixed dimension and rank the conversion has linear size [14, Section 2.3, after Example 2]. □

Proof of Proposition 3.12. Apply (a)–(d) to the trimmed input and trim again. Each stage multiplies the encoding by a factor depending only on $f, r_{\max}$ and trimming can only decrease it, so $\|G_{\mathrm{good}}\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$, and $L(G_{\mathrm{good}}) = L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$ by (c). If this language is nonempty, the start symbol is productive and the final trimming leaves a reduced grammar; trimming preserves goodness. □

Thickness transfer for λ-free presentations

Proposition F.2 (Thickness under good-form conversion)**.** *Fix f and $r_{\max}$. Let G_{in} be a reduced λ-free f-MCFG of maximum rule rank at most $r_{\max}$, possibly with deleting rules, and suppose $L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \cap \Sigma^+ \neq \emptyset$. The good normalization of Proposition 3.12 yields an equivalent reduced good grammar G with the same fan-out and rule-rank bounds such that*

$$\|G\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|), \qquad t_G \le t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}, \qquad \theta_G = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\| \max\{1, t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}\}).$$

Proof. Because G_{in} is λ-free, every component of every derived tuple is nonempty, by induction on derivations; this persists through (a) and (b), so stage (c) is the identity. By Lemma F.1, every nonterminal X of the final grammar is associated with an original nonterminal A such that

$$L_X(G) = \mu(\sigma\pi_I(L_A(G_{\mathrm{in}}))), \qquad \min_{\vec{u}\in L_X(G)} \|\vec{u}\|_1 \le \min_{\vec{w}\in L_A(G_{\mathrm{in}})} \|\vec{w}\|_1.$$

Trimming leaves the tuple languages of surviving nonterminals unchanged, so $t_G \le t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}$, and the size bound was shown above. Finally Lemma 4.1(iii) gives $\theta_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\} = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\| \max\{1, t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}\})$. □

Thus deleting rules do not by themselves obstruct polynomial thickness transfer from a reduced λ-free presentation; genuinely empty components are the problematic step in the scale comparison of Table 1.

Proposition F.3 (Empty-component elimination can blow up thickness)**.** *For every $n \ge 1$ there is a reduced fan-out-two, rule-rank-two MCFG E_n of size $O(n)$ with $t_{E_n} \le 2$ and $\theta_{E_n} = O(n)$ such that the empty-component elimination stage of Proposition 3.12 contains a retained nonterminal and a retained rule of thickness at least 2^n.*

Proof. Let E_n have fan-out-one S, fan-out-two $A_0,\dots,A_n$, and

$$A_0 \to (\mathtt{a}, \varepsilon), \qquad A_i \to (\varepsilon, \mathtt{c}) \mid (\xi_1^1\xi_2^1, \xi_1^2\xi_2^2)(A_{i-1}, A_{i-1}) \quad (1 \le i \le n), \qquad S \to (\xi_1^1 \mathtt{d}\, \xi_1^2)(A_n).$$

It is reduced, nondeleting, nonpermuting, and nonmerging. Short side derivations give $t_{E_n} \le 2$, and placing any chosen rule on one branch of the binary spine while completing siblings minimally gives $\theta_{E_n} = O(n)$. If an A_i-tuple has nonempty first and empty second component, the rule $(\varepsilon, \mathtt{c})$ cannot occur in it; inductively the shortest such tuple is $(\mathtt{a}^{2^i}, \varepsilon)$. Thus pattern $\{1\}$ for A_n survives, and the projected start rule $S \to \xi_1^1 \mathtt{d}\, (A_n^{\{1\}})$ succeeds only with a child of length at least 2^n. □

This is a distinct obstruction from Proposition 4.4: here a *support pattern* forces an exponentially long tuple already in the source presentation, while the earlier example concerns the thickness of a *typed refinement*. Neither assertion alone is an operator-independent characteristic-data lower bound.

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the manuscript preparation process

During preparation of this work, the author used ChatGPT (OpenAI) and Claude (Anthropic) to assist with organization of the manuscript, expression and translation of text, cross-checks of references and notation, and editing of LaTeX source. After using these tools, the author reviewed and edited the material as needed and takes full responsibility for the content of the publication.

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